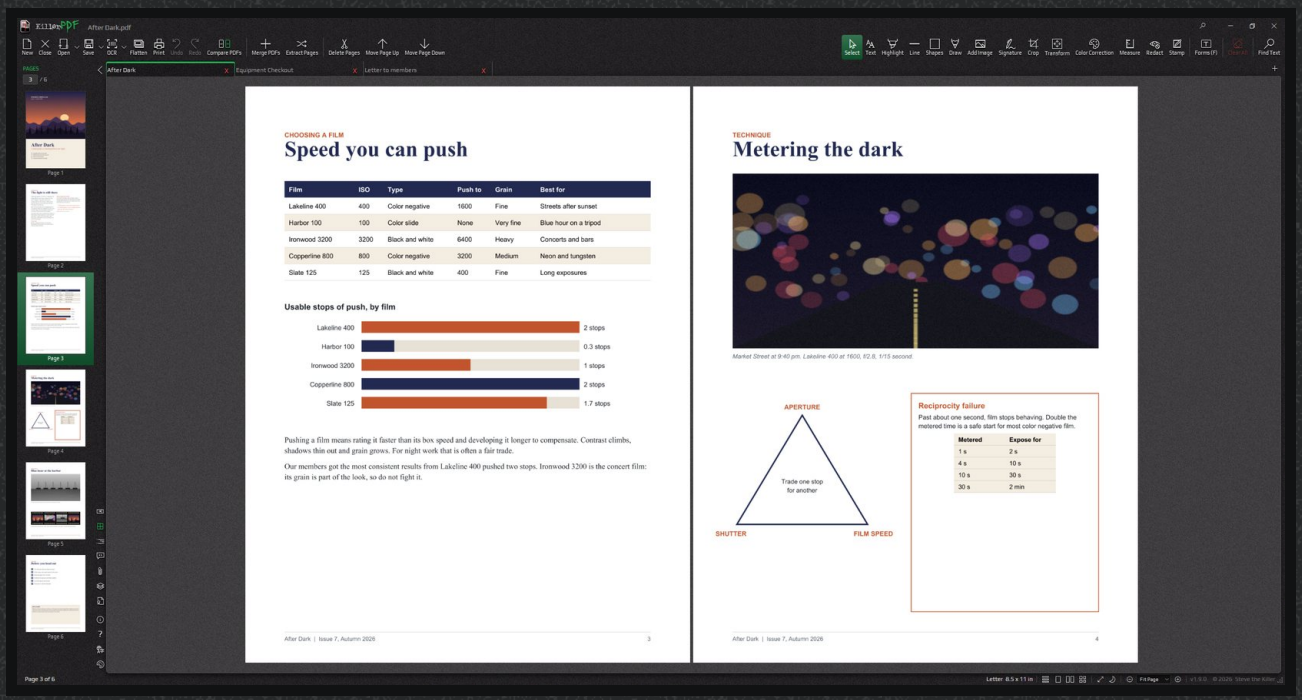
# KillerPDF

## Feature guide

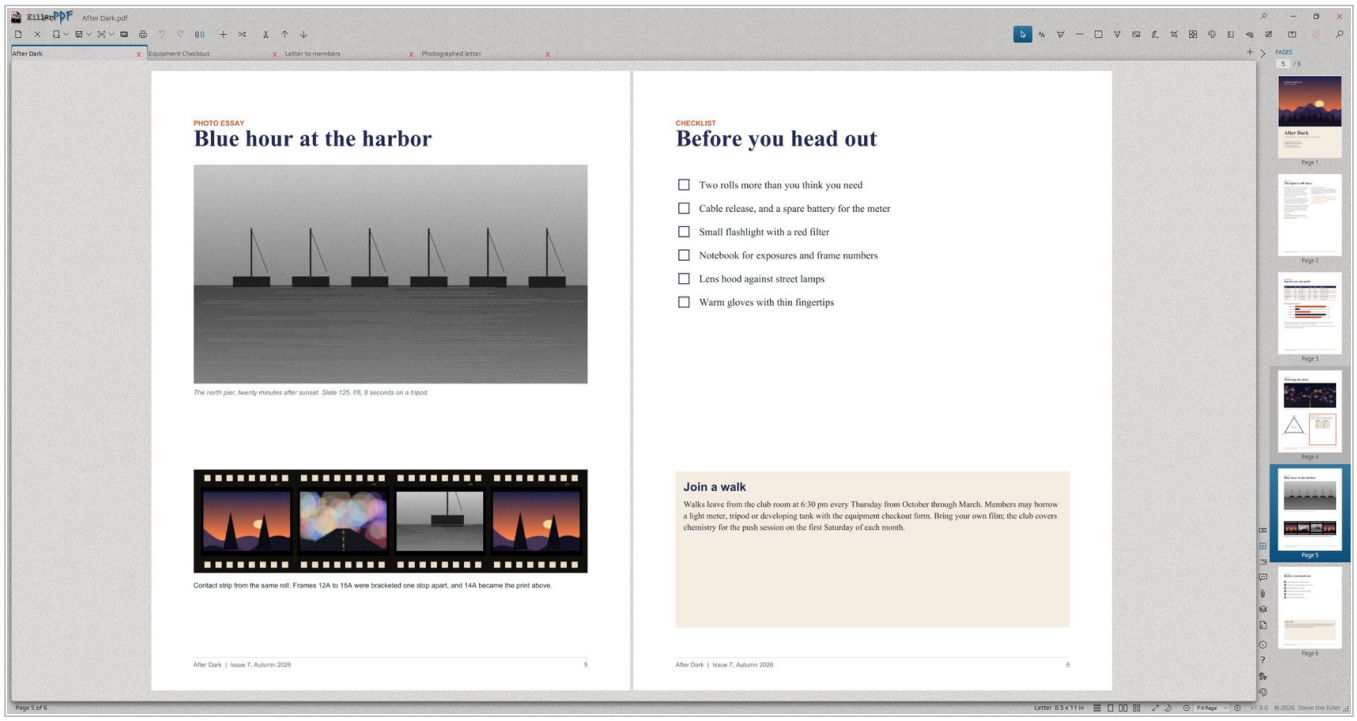
**VERSION 1.9**




A free, open source PDF editor for Windows, with its own PDF engine.

# Welcome to KillerPDF

KillerPDF is a free PDF viewer and editor for Windows. You can read, annotate, organize, compare, fill, sign, OCR and batch process PDFs on your own computer, with no account.




*KillerPDF maximized in the Light theme with the Blue accent, four tabs open and the sidebar on the right.*

## What it is

KillerPDF is a desktop app for Windows, released under the GPL-3.0 license and part of the Killer Tools family. Version 1.9, named Overkill, runs on KillerPDF's own PDF engine, which handles rendering, text extraction, search, editing, printing and export. There is no account to create, and the project describes itself as local-only with no telemetry. It is for anyone who works with PDFs on Windows and prefers to keep the files on their own machine.

## At a glance

- 13 themes and 8 accent colors
- 20 interface languages
- 4 view modes plus Book layout
- 6 sidebar panels
- 32 buttons on the default toolbar
- App size from 70 to 250 percent

# What is new in 1.9

Version 1.9 replaces the engine under the app and adds a lot on top of it. These are the biggest changes.

### Engine

- KillerPDF's own engine replaces PDFium, Docnet.Core and PdfPig for rendering, text, search, selection, editing, printing and export.
- Rendering runs off the UI thread, with viewport priority, cancellation and zoom refinement.
- Damaged PDFs open and save more reliably, including encrypted documents and forms.

### Editing and documents

- Edit paragraphs, and use Find and Replace on supported source text.
- Convert Scan to Text swaps scanned words for searchable text.
- Export to Word, Excel, PowerPoint, HTML, Markdown, text and JSON.
- Form tools, page tools, production tools and Convert DOCX or XLSX directly to PDF.

### Security

- Permanent redaction by area, text search or sensitive-data pattern, with verification.
- Save AES-256 encrypted copies with passwords, permissions or certificate recipients.
- Inspect signers and certificate chains, with RFC 3161 timestamps.
- Updates install only after a checksum and publisher signature check.

### Workspace and automation

- Search Tools (Ctrl+K), customizable shortcuts and one-letter tool keys.
- Six sidebar panels, four sidebar positions, Windows 11 snap layouts and a Film Grain switch.
- Guided tasks, macros, watched folders and Data merge for CSV, JSON or XLSX.
- Command-line workflows with flexible splitting, single-input merging and batch rendering.

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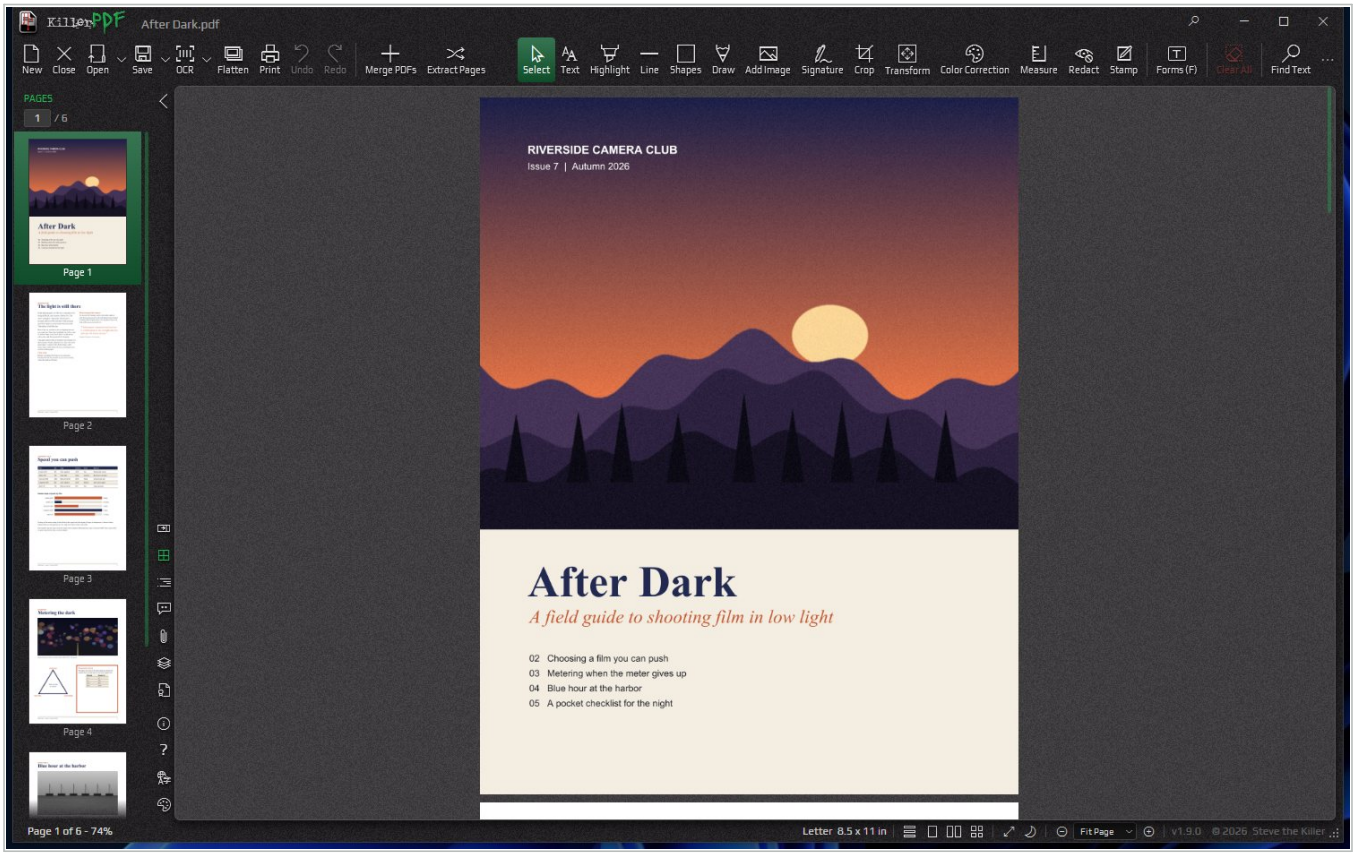
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# The workspace

- Views, panels, tabs and split panes
- Thirteen themes and eight accents
- Toolbar, search and navigation

# A tour of the main window

The window has the same few regions in every theme. Knowing where each one lives makes the rest of this guide easier to follow.




*The standard window in the Dark theme.*

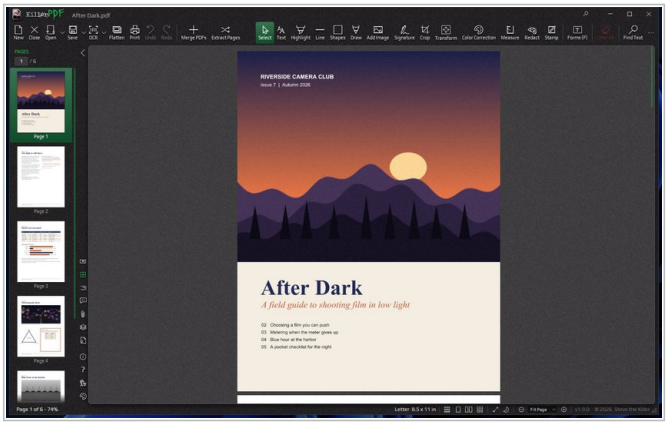
## The regions

| Region | What is there |
|---|---|
| **Title bar** | Window controls and Search Tools, the magnifier left of Minimize. Optional Previous and Next page buttons can be turned on here. |
| **Toolbar** | The tool buttons. Right-click it to customize. |
| **Tab strip** | One tab per open document, one strip per pane. |
| **Sidebar rail** | Collapse, Split pane, the six panel buttons, Document info, Keyboard shortcuts, Language and Theme. |
| **Sidebar panel** | Pages, Outline, Comments and measurements, Attachments, Layers or Signatures. |
| **Document area** | The pages you are reading or editing. |
| **Footer** | Status line, page size, zoom, view modes, Invert colors, Full screen and the version label. |

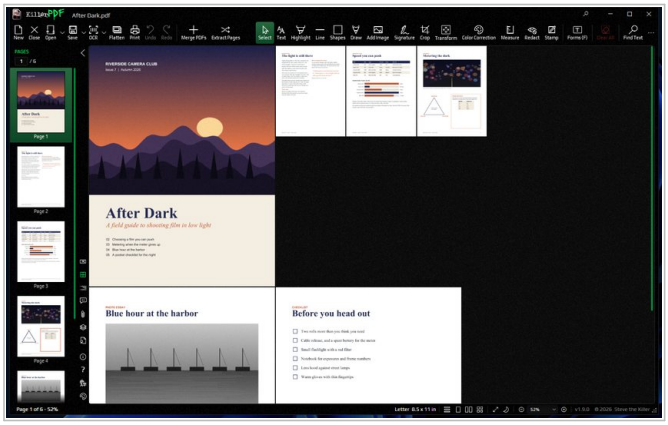
**Tip.** The window opens at 1000 by 700 pixels and can shrink to 620 by 480. Click the version label in the footer, or press F12, to open the About card.

# View modes, zoom and fit

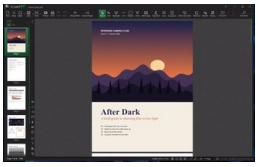
KillerPDF shows a document four ways, plus a Book layout for facing pages. Switch from the footer buttons or with the function keys.



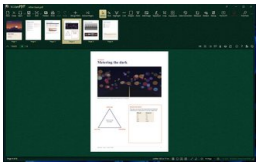

*Continuous view, the default for a document with no saved state.*



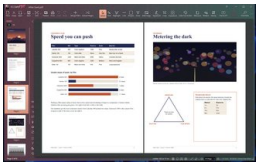

*Grid view shows thumbnails of the whole document.*



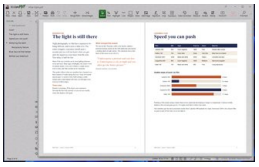
**Continuous (F5)**



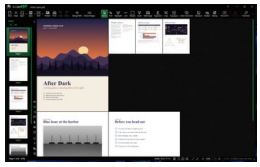
**Single Page (F6)**



**Two Page (F7)**



**Book layout (B)**



**Grid (F8)**

## The five ways to view

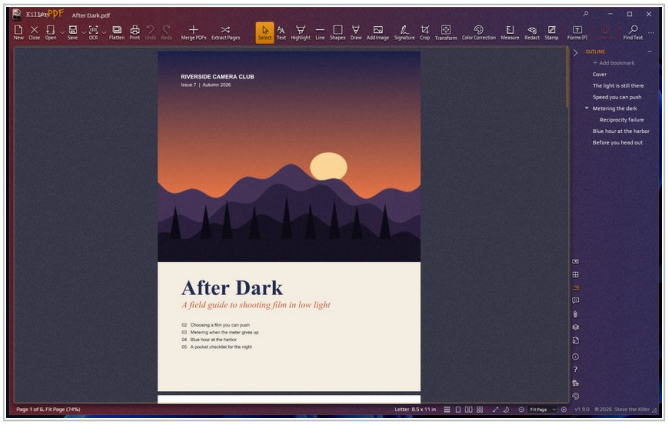
| View | Key | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **Continuous** | F5 | Pages scroll in one column. |
| **Single Page** | F6 | One page at a time. |
| **Two Page** | F7 | Two pages side by side. |
| **Book layout** | B | Works in Two Page. The cover sits alone in its row. |
| **Grid** | F8 | Zoom changes the number of columns. |

## Zoom and fit

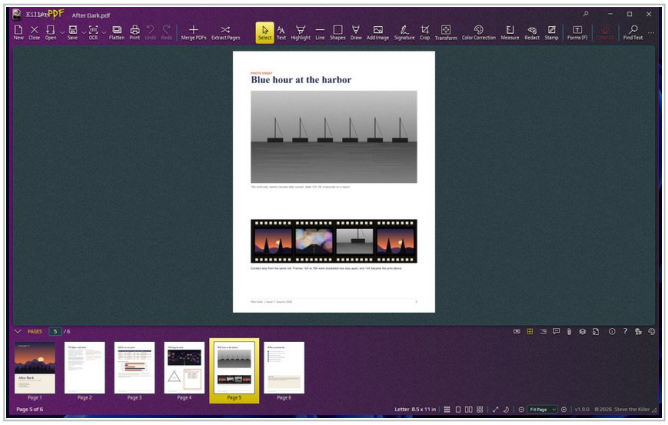
- The footer zoom box offers Fit Page, Fit Width, 50, 75, 100, 125, 150 and 200 percent.
- Ctrl+0 resets to 100 percent. Ctrl+1 is Actual size, Ctrl+2 Fit width, Ctrl+3 Fit page.
- In Continuous, Single Page and Two Page, Ctrl+scroll zooms around the pointer. In Grid it changes the number of columns. Pinch works on touch and precision touchpads.
- Each document remembers its view, zoom, page and scroll position, for your 40 most recent documents.

# The sidebar

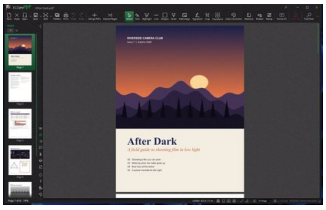
The sidebar is a rail of icon buttons and one panel at a time. It can sit on any of the four sides of the window.



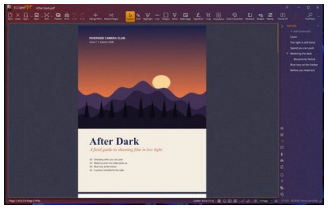

*The sidebar on the right.*



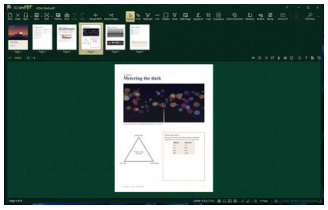

*The sidebar along the bottom.*



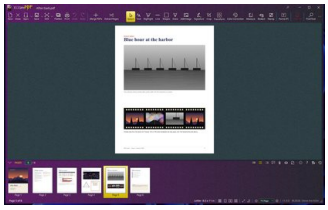
**Left (the default)**



**Right**



**Top**



**Bottom**

### The six panels

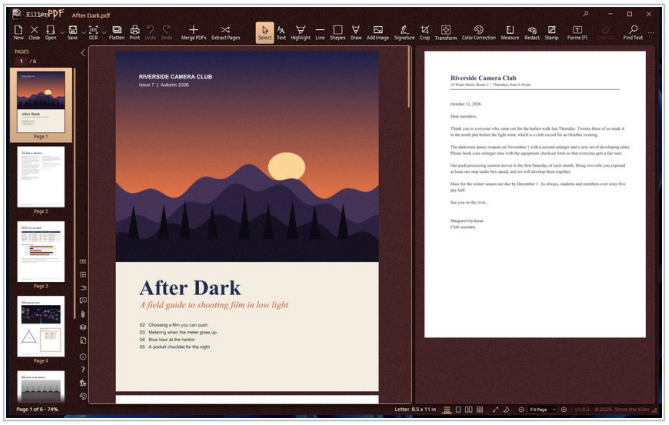
| Panel | Key |
|---|---|
| **Pages** | Alt+1 |
| **Outline** | Alt+2 |
| **Comments and measurements** | Alt+3 |
| **Attachments** | Alt+4 |
| **Layers** | Alt+5 |
| **Signatures** | Alt+6 |

### Position and behavior

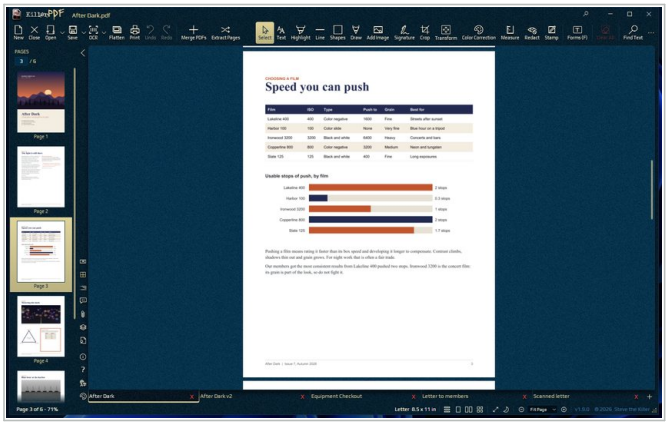
- Press F9 to show or hide the sidebar.
- Closing or opening the panel with its arrow or F9 is remembered next time you start KillerPDF.
- Press Shift+F9 to move it to the next side: Left, Right, Top, then Bottom.
- The rail also offers Move icons to the other side, and it remembers the order of its buttons.
- Panel buttons stay disabled until a document is open. Outline also stays disabled for a read-only document without bookmarks.

# Tabs and split panes

Every document opens in a tab. Press F10 and a second pane lets you read two documents side by side.




*Two documents side by side with F10.*




*The tab strip placed along the bottom.*

## Tabs

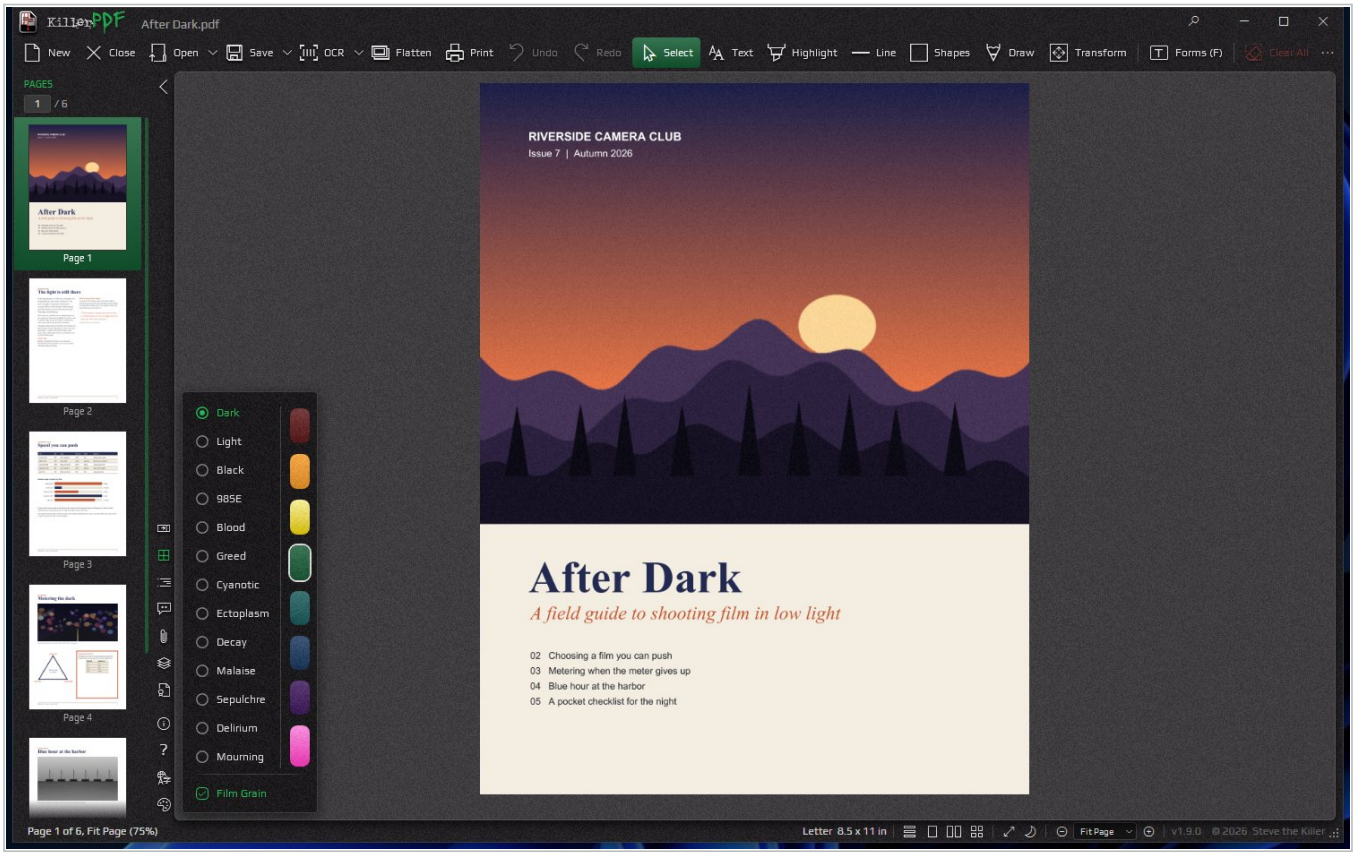
- Alt+Shift+Up puts the strip on top. Alt+Shift+Down puts it on the bottom.
- Tabs that do not fit move into an overflow chevron, All open tabs.
- Drag a tab to reorder it. Drag it over the other pane to move it there without reloading.
- Drag a tab out past the window edge, or press Ctrl+Shift+N, to move it to a new window.
- Ctrl+Tab and Ctrl+Shift+Tab step through tabs.

## Split panes

- Each pane keeps its own tabs, page, zoom, view mode, scroll position, tool, annotations, undo stack and night mode.
- The toolbar, sidebar, footer and status line are shared. The focused pane receives every command.
- A pane is at least 320 pixels wide. The split and its tabs come back at next launch.

# Themes

KillerPDF has 13 themes. Open the Theme button on the sidebar rail to pick one. The change cross-fades, and no restart is needed.




*The theme menu with the theme list, accent swatches and Film Grain.*

### The thirteen themes

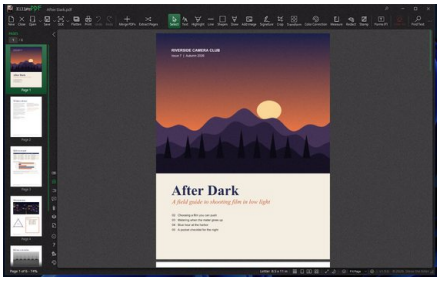
In menu order: Dark, Light, Black, 98SE, Blood, Greed, Cyanotic, Ectoplasm, Decay, Malaise, Sepulchre, Delirium and Mourning. A first run starts in Dark with the Green accent. Ectoplasm, Decay, Sepulchre, Delirium and Malaise use gradients for the window background and title bar.

### What makes 98SE different

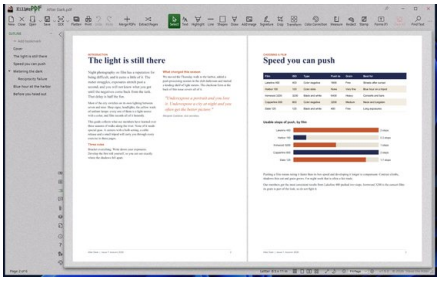
- It recreates classic beveled Windows chrome, with square corners.
- The interface font is Microsoft Sans Serif.
- It keeps a gray document workspace and uses light window chrome.
- It has no film grain.

# All thirteen themes

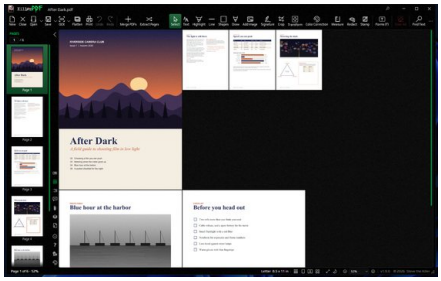
Every theme recolors the whole window: title bar, toolbar, rail, tabs, panels and footer. Each shot below also shows a different part of the workspace.



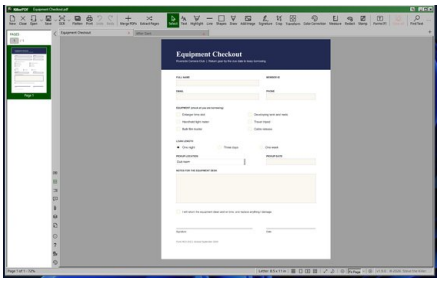

**Dark: Continuous view, Pages panel**



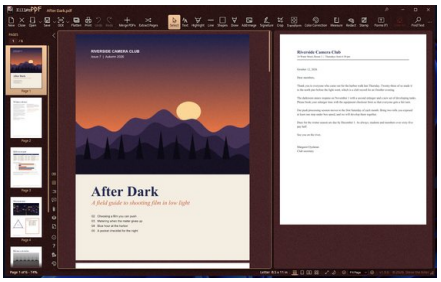

**Light: Book layout, Outline panel**



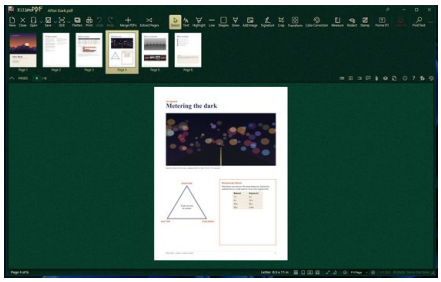

**Black: Grid view**



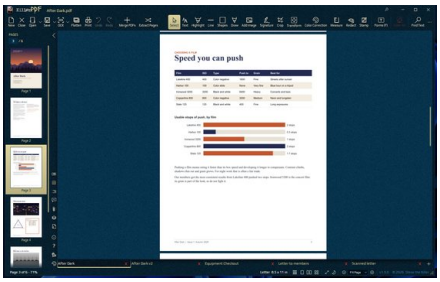

**98SE: the checkout form**



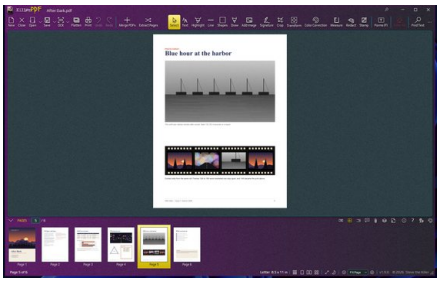

**Blood: split pane**



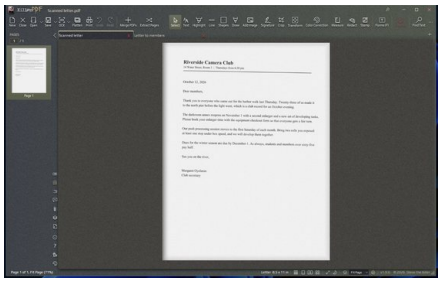

**Greed: sidebar on top**



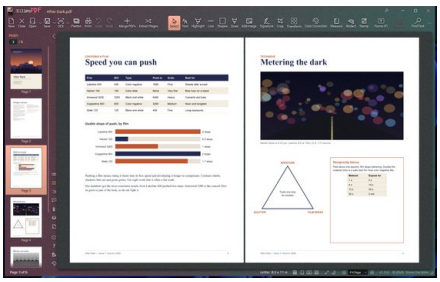

**Cyanotic: tabs on the bottom**



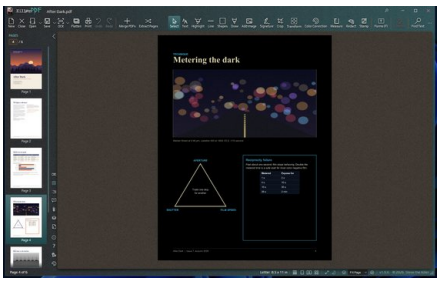

**Ectoplasm: sidebar on the bottom**



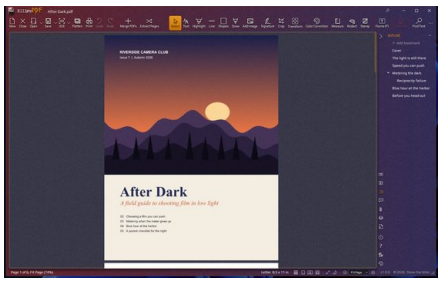
**Decay: a scanned letter**



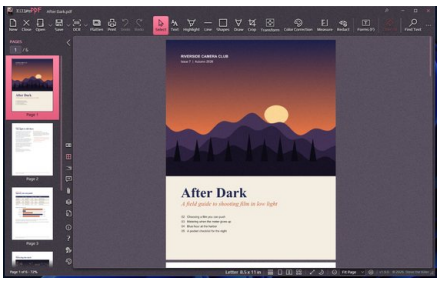

**Malaise: Two Page view**




**Sepulchre: night mode**



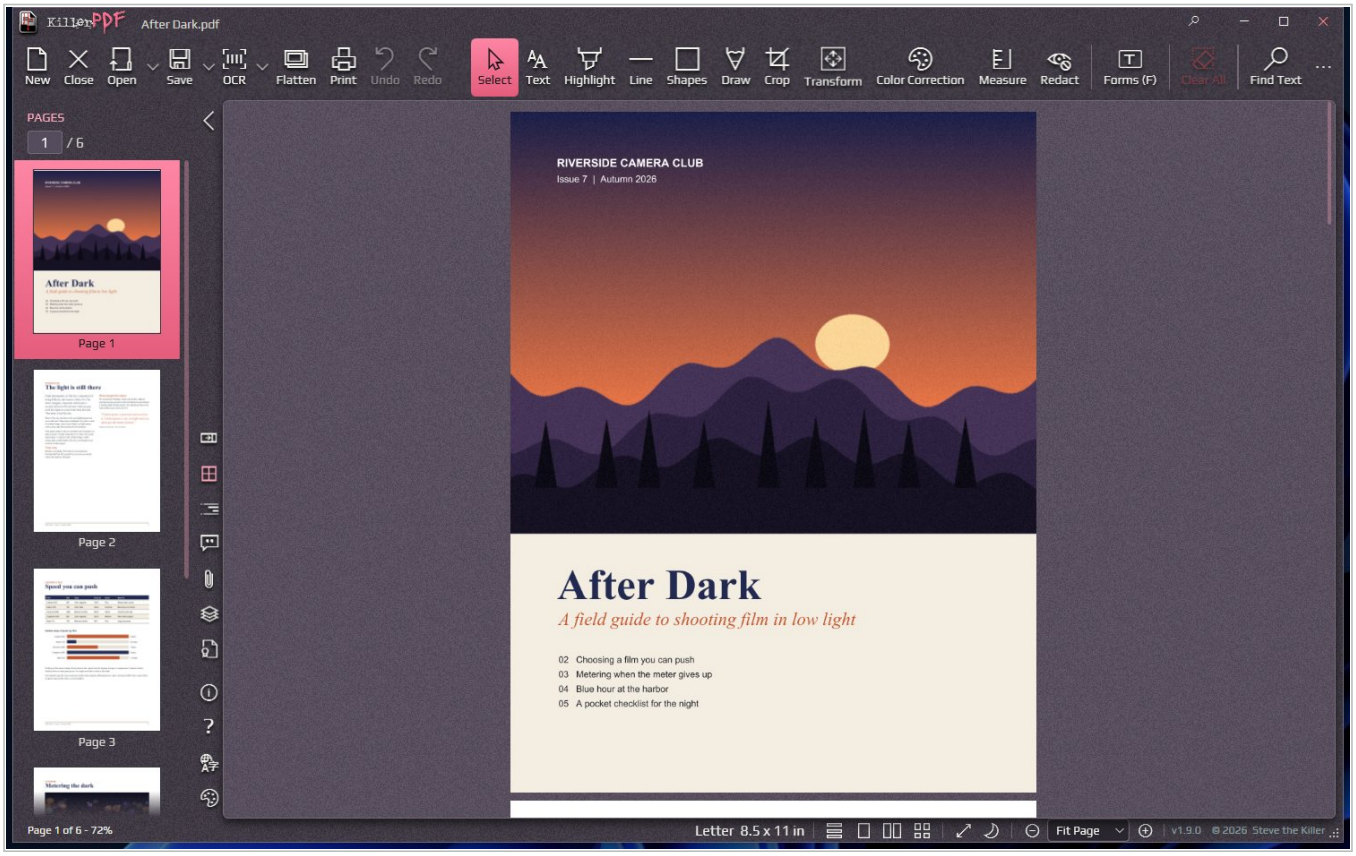

**Delirium: sidebar on the right**




**Mourning: a larger app size**

# Accents, grain and app size

Four themes take an accent color. Film Grain, app size and Windows contrast themes round out how the app looks.




*The interface at a larger app size.*

### Accents and Film Grain

- Eight accents: Red, Orange, Yellow, Green, Teal, Blue, Purple and Magenta.
- Only Dark, Light, Black and 98SE take accents, and each remembers its own.
- Pick an accent from the swatch strip beside the theme list. Arrow keys move between swatches.
- Film Grain is a switch under the theme list, on by default. Press Alt+Shift+G to toggle it.

### Change the app size

1. Press Ctrl+Shift++ to make the interface larger.
2. Press Ctrl+Shift+- to make it smaller.
3. Press Ctrl+Shift+0 to reset to 100 percent.
4. Or turn the mouse wheel over the logo. The range is 70 to 250 percent.

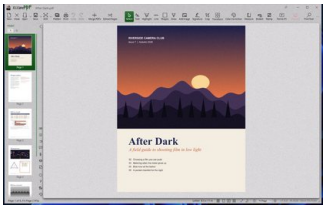
### Windows contrast themes

When Windows contrast colors are on, KillerPDF uses the system colors without grain or shadows. It follows the Windows setting live. The Black theme is an ordinary theme, not a contrast mode.

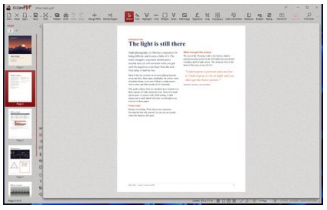
# Eight accents on Light and Dark

Dark, Light, Black and 98SE take an accent, and each remembers its own. The accent colors the selected tool, the checked items and the highlights around the window.

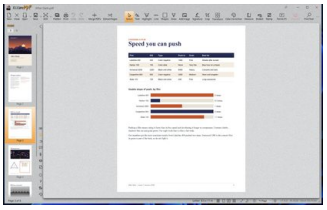
## Light



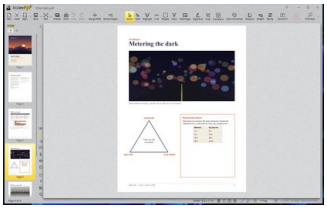

**Green**



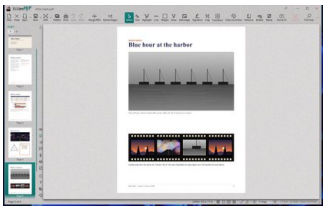

**Red**



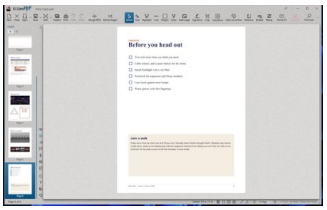

**Orange**



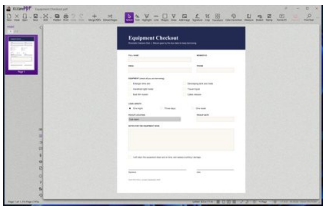

**Yellow**



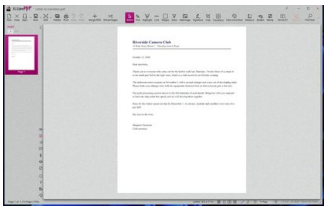

**Teal**




**Blue**

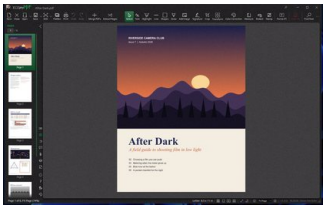



**Purple**

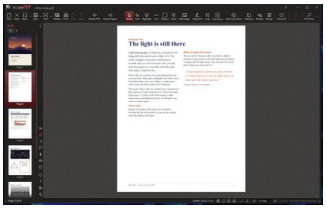


**Magenta**

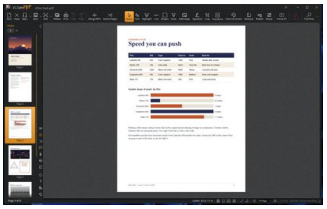
## Dark



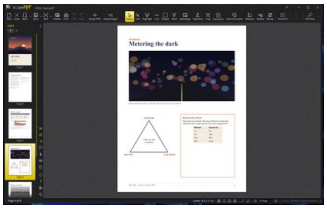

**Green**



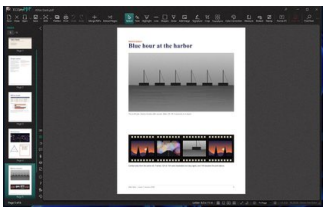

**Red**



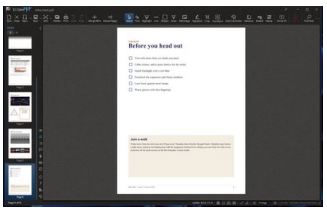

**Orange**



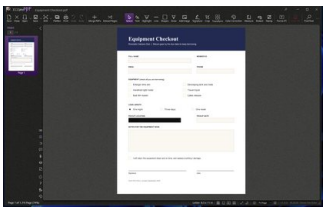

**Yellow**



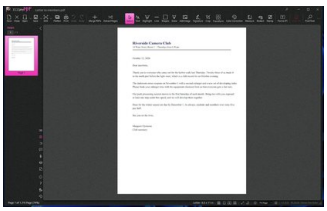

**Teal**




**Blue**



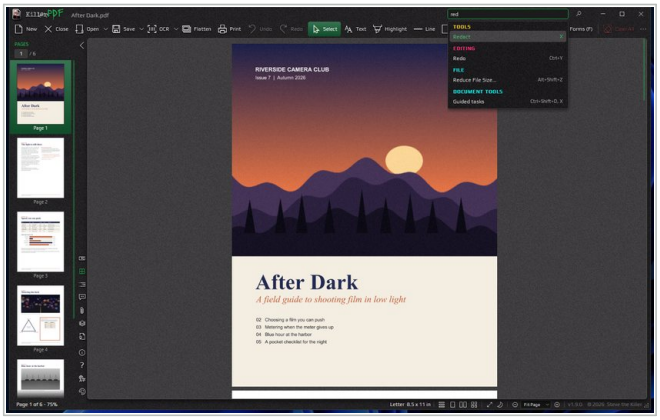

**Purple**



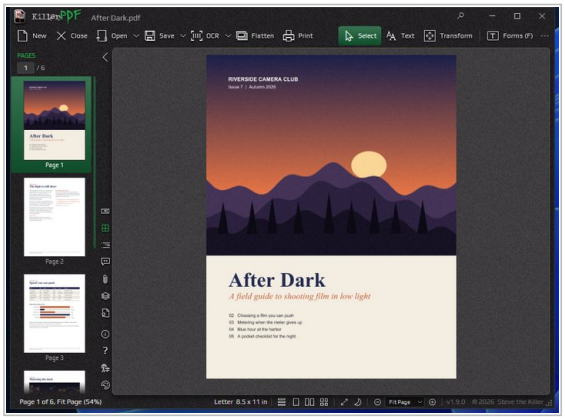
**Magenta**

# The toolbar and Search Tools

The default toolbar has 32 buttons. You can restyle it, reorder it, or skip it and search for any command.



*Search Tools listing matching commands.*



*A narrow window with tools moved into the More menu.*




**Small icons, large icons, text beside, text under, text only, and large icons with text under**

## Use Search Tools

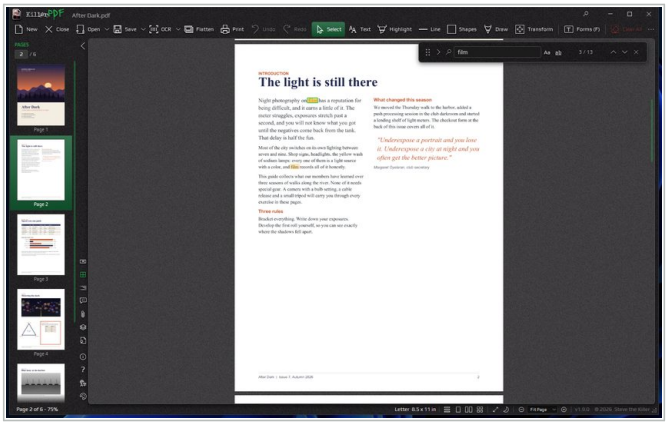
1. Press Ctrl+K, or click the magnifier left of Minimize.
2. Start typing a tool or command name.
3. Press Enter or click a result to run it.

## Toolbar behavior

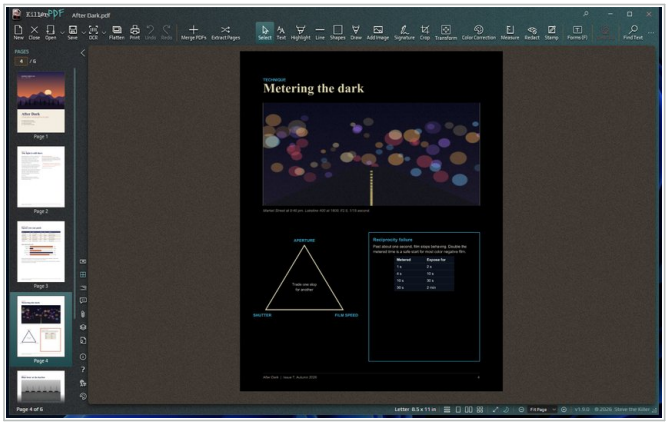
- Two settings combine: icon size, Small (Ctrl+Shift+1) or Large (Ctrl+Shift+2), and where the text goes, none (Ctrl+Shift+3), beside the icons (4), under them (5) or text only (6).
- Right-click the toolbar and choose Customize toolbar to reorder buttons, choose the side and move buttons to More.
- As the window narrows, groups move into the More chevron. Select and the active tool stay on the bar.
- Alt+M hides the toolbar.

# Finding things and moving around

Search, history, night mode and full screen each have a single key. The shortcuts card lists everything.




*Find Text with matches highlighted.*




*Invert document colors on the photo page.*

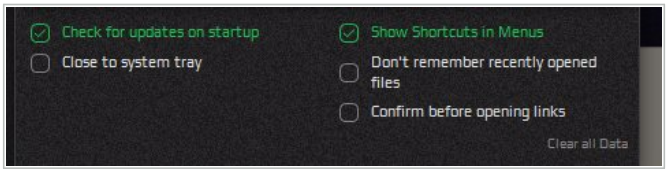
## Quick reference

| Feature | Key | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **Back and forward** | Alt+Left, Alt+Right | Jump history. The mouse back and forward buttons work too. |
| **Find Text** | Ctrl+F | A bar you can drag. Alt+C matches case, Alt+W whole words. |
| **Find and Replace** | Ctrl+H | Enter replaces one. Ctrl+Alt+Enter replaces all. |
| **Night mode** | N | Display only. Shift+N inverts images too. |
| **Full screen** | F11 | Hides all chrome. F11 or Esc leaves. |
| **Page buttons** | Alt+Shift+N | Optional Previous and Next in the title bar. |
| **Shortcuts card** | F1 | A list and a keyboard map. |

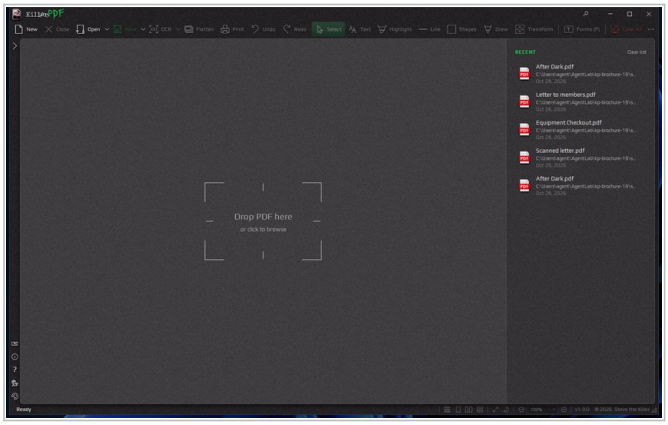
**Tip.** Night mode affects only the focused pane, so a split can show one document inverted beside a normal one.

# Where settings live

There is no Settings panel in 1.9. Each setting lives next to the thing it changes, and the rest are on the About card.




*The settings on the About card (F12).*




*The start screen with the recent files list.*

## Where to find them

| Setting | Where |
|---|---|
| **Theme, accent, Film Grain** | Rail, Theme button |
| **Language** | Rail, Language button |
| **View, zoom, night mode** | Footer |
| **Toolbar style and layout** | Toolbar right-click menu |
| **Sidebar side, tab placement** | Sidebar and tab menus |
| **Update check, Close to system tray, Show Shortcuts in Menus, Don't remember recently opened files, Confirm before opening links, Clear all Data** | About card (F12) |

## Remembering and recovery

- Recent files: the 10 most recent appear on the start screen.
- Open tabs, window size and the split restore at next launch. Ticking Close my open tabs in the quit prompt turns tab restore off. Don't remember recently opened files only stops the recent files list.
- If the display fails, unsaved documents are saved aside and the app restarts in software rendering.

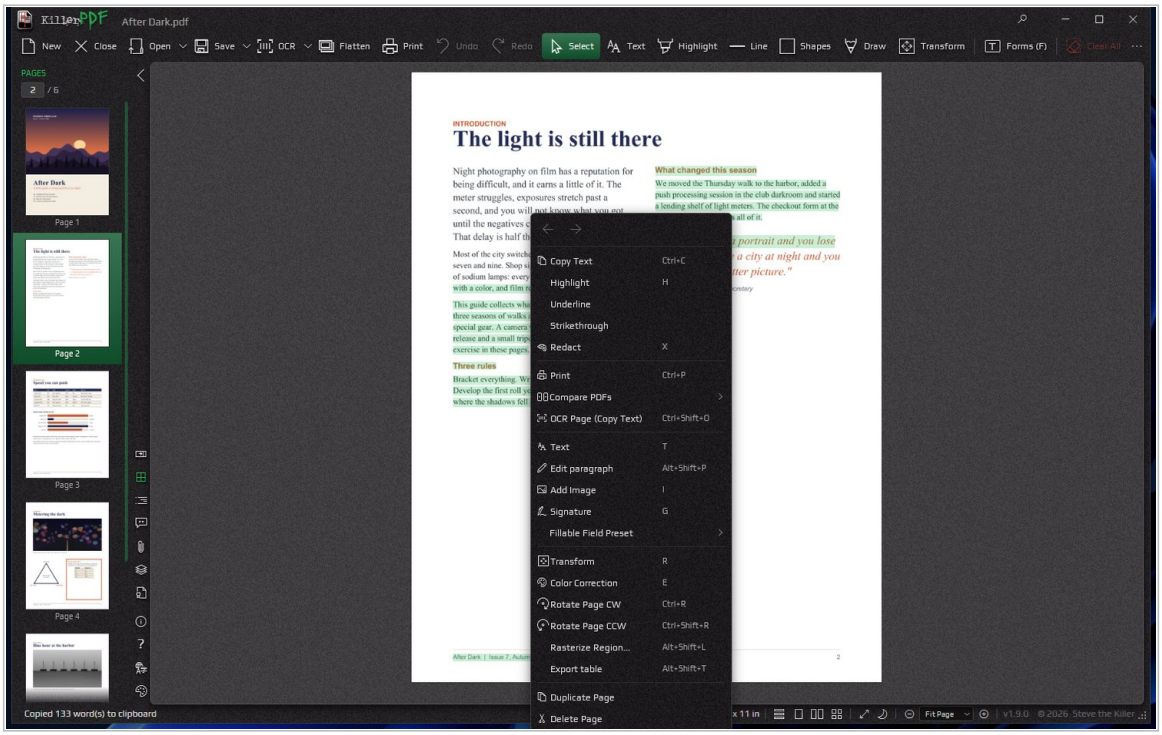
II

# Markup and review

- Text, highlight, draw and shapes
- Images, measurements and comments
- Page numbers and watermarks

# How markup works

Markup is how you put your own marks on a page. Drawn markup is written into the page content when you save, while measurements and comments stay real PDF annotations that reopen for editing.




*Right-click a text selection to highlight, underline, strike through or redact it.*

### Tool keys

| Tool | Default key |
|---|---|
| **Select** | V |
| **Text** | T |
| **Highlight** | H |
| **Line** | L or U |
| **Shapes** | O (Shift+O picks the next shape) |
| **Draw** | D |
| **Add Image** | I |
| **Signature** | G |
| **Stamp Pages** | S |
| **Forms** | F |
| **Measure** | M (Shift+M picks the next type) |

### Undo and Clear All

The Undo and Redo buttons cover annotations, text edits, stamps and document edits. Clear All on the toolbar removes every annotation. To clear one page, right-click it and choose Clear Page Annotations. The keys above are defaults, and you can remap them.

# Select, group and arrange

The Select tool picks up anything you have drawn so you can move it, restyle it, stack it or delete it.

### Work with what you drew

1. Press V or click Select on the toolbar.
2. Click an annotation to select it. Shift+click adds more to the selection.
3. Drag to move it. Double-click to edit it.
4. Press the arrow keys to nudge the selection. It stays inside the page.
5. Press Ctrl+C, then Ctrl+V to copy and paste.
6. Press Delete to remove the selection.
7. Right-click for Raise, Lower and Group selected.

### Right-click menu

- Edit, Raise, Lower, Copy, Paste and Delete Selected.
- Raise and Lower are enabled only when something overlaps in that direction.
- Group selected, Ungroup and Remove from group.
- Select cover, Select text and Unpair text + cover for edited page text.
- A highlight drag across several lines is grouped per page, so it moves and deletes together.

> **Tip.** Changing a color, size or opacity on the tool bar while something is selected restyles that object.

# Text and typewriter

Type onto a page, or click existing page text to edit that line in place.

## How to use it

1. Press T or click Text on the toolbar.
2. Click the page and start typing.
3. Press Enter for a new line.
4. Press Ctrl+Enter to commit the box. Escape cancels.
5. To fix existing text, click it with the Text tool and edit the line.
6. Press Ctrl+B, Ctrl+I or Ctrl+U to toggle bold, italic or underline while typing.

## Text bar

| Option | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Color, Fill** | Text color and a background behind it |
| **Size** | 8 to 72 points |
| **Spacing** | -2 to 20 points |
| **Font** | Any installed font family |
| **Bold, Italic, Strikethrough, Underline** | Toggles |
| **Opacity, Fill Opacity** | Text and background transparency |

## Good to know

- Editing an existing line temporarily shows its appearance in the text bar. Your defaults for new text stay separate.
- In a narrow window, expand the text bar's opacity controls when you need them.
- Ctrl+V pastes clipboard text as a text box. Escape cancels an active text edit.

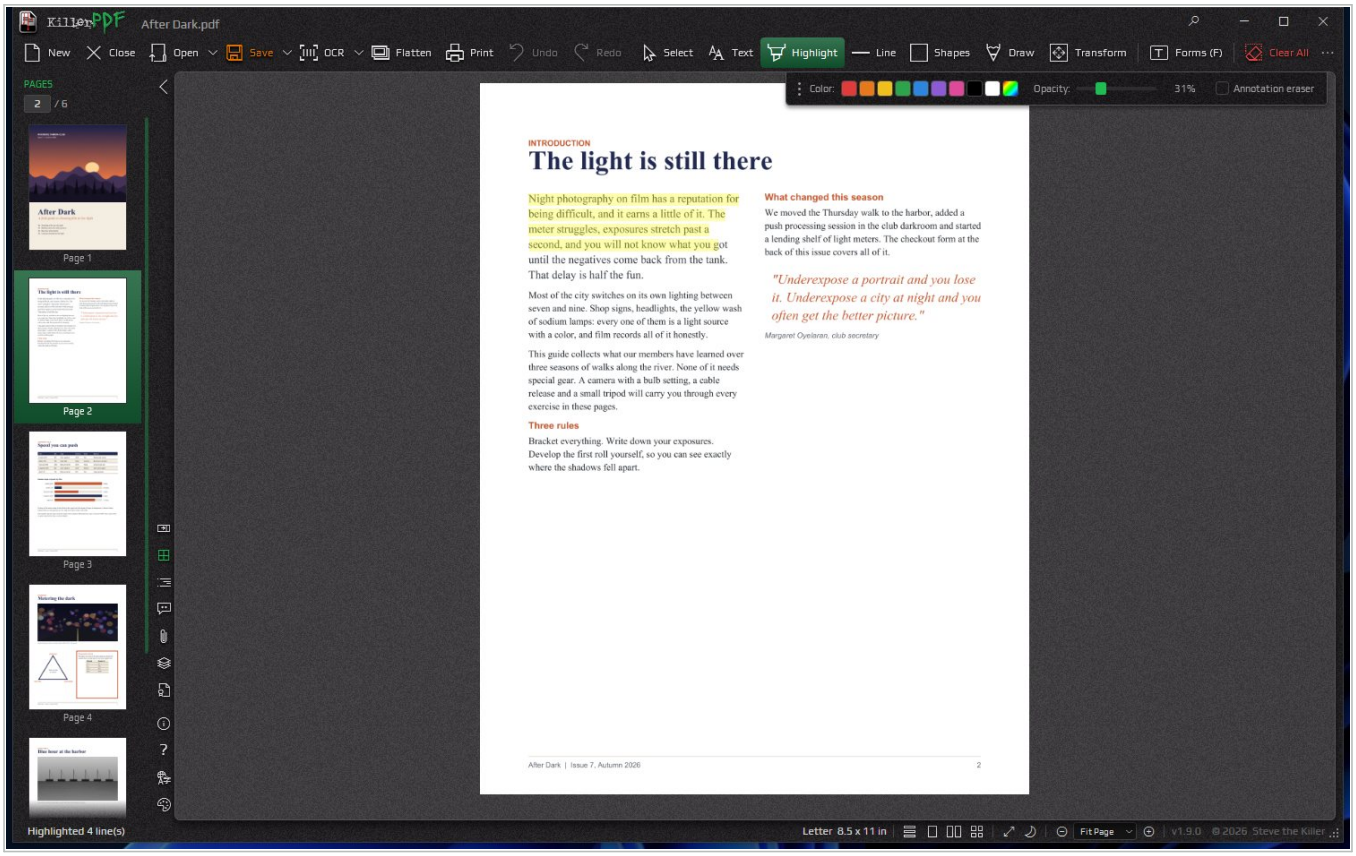
## Edit a paragraph

1. Press Alt+Shift+P and select a paragraph on the page beside the editing options.
2. Resize its box with the corner handle or size fields, then edit the text and preview the result.
3. Review font substitutions, mixed-style warnings and uncertain word joins before applying.
4. Click Apply to replace the paragraph. If the text will not fit or cannot be edited safely, read the explanation and adjust your selection or options.

Scanned pages need OCR before paragraph editing. Tables, neighboring columns and overlapping content can prevent an edit. Unsupported shaping and unidentified characters are explained instead of silently changed.

# Highlight, underline and strikethrough

Mark up the words you drag across. The mark follows the text lines instead of drawing a box.




*Highlighted lines with the highlight bar.*

## How to use it

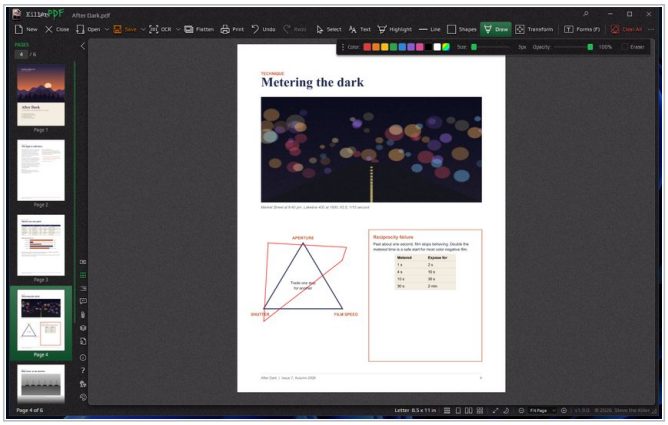
1. Press H or click Highlight on the toolbar.
2. Drag across the words. You get one highlight per line, and one Ctrl+Z reverts the whole drag.
3. For underline or strikethrough, select the text, right-click and choose Underline or Strikethrough.
4. To delete marks in bulk, tick Annotation eraser on the highlight bar and drag a box around them.

## Good to know

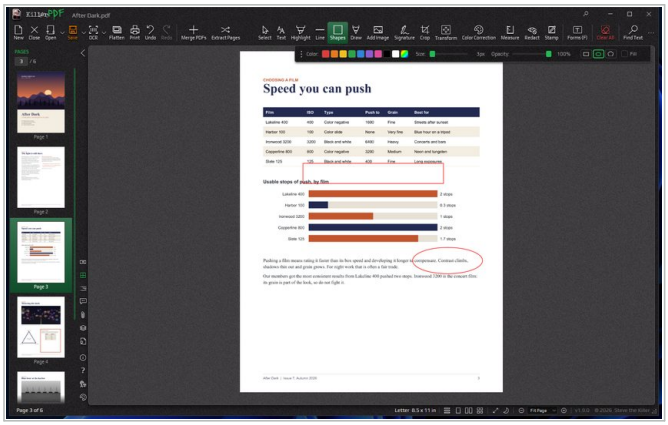
- The highlight bar has Color, Opacity and the Annotation eraser.
- Underline and strikethrough keep their own color and opacity. The default is opaque red.
- There is no toolbar button for underline or strikethrough.
- On a page with no text layer, KillerPDF shows a hint instead of drawing.

# Draw, lines and shapes

Sketch freehand, draw straight lines, or drop in boxes, ellipses and freeform shapes.




*Freehand ink with the draw bar.*




*A box, an ellipse and a freeform shape on a page.*

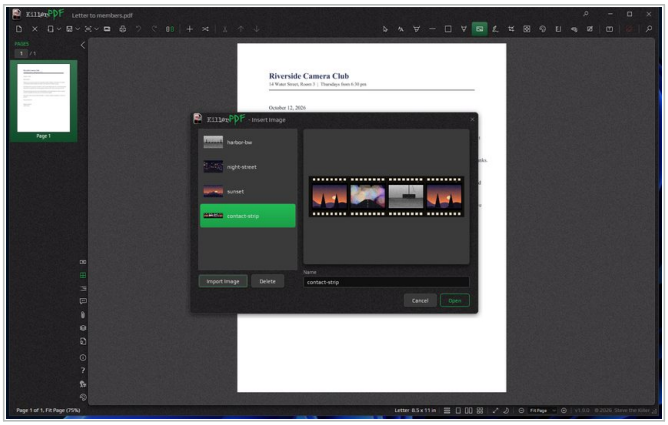
## How to use it

1. Press D and drag to draw freehand.
2. Press L and drag for a straight line. Tick Level to keep it horizontal or vertical.
3. Press O and pick Box, Ellipse or Freeform.
4. Drag for a box or an ellipse.
5. For Freeform, click each point. Click the first point, double-click or press Enter to close. Backspace removes the last point.
6. Tick Eraser on the draw bar and brush over marks to delete them.

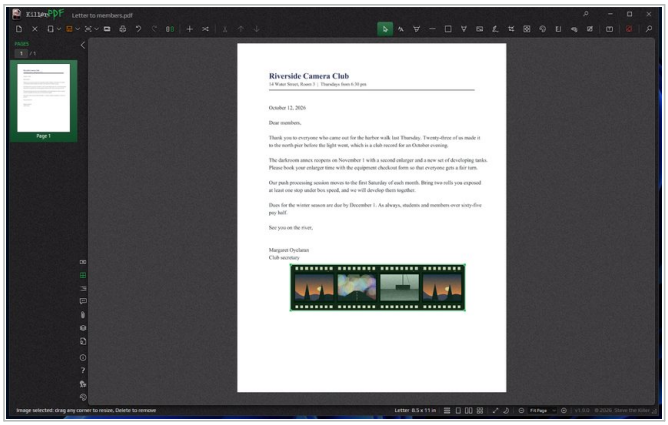
| Option | Range |
|---|---|
| **Size** | 1 to 60 px |
| **Opacity** | About 4 to 100 percent |
| **Fill** | On or off for shapes, on by default |
| **Shift+O** | Cycles Box, Ellipse, Freeform |

# Add Image and the image library

Put a logo, photo or scan on a page. Images you add are kept in a library you can reuse.



*The image library with four saved photos.*



*A contact strip placed on the club letter, still selected for moving.*

## How to use it

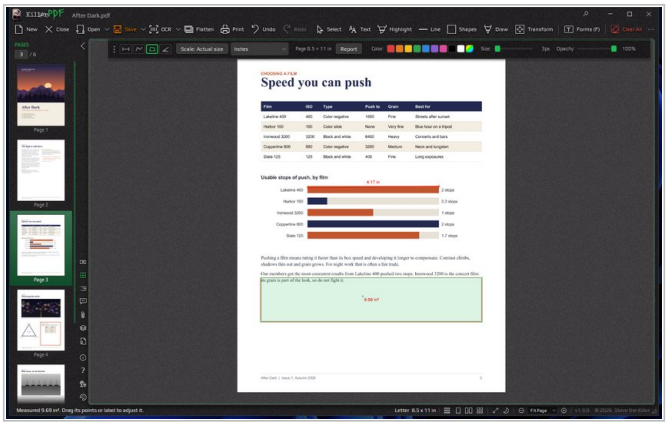
1. Press I or click the Image tool on the toolbar.
2. Click the page where the image should go. The image library opens.
3. Pick a saved image, or click Import Image to add a file, then click Open.
4. The image's top left corner lands where you clicked. Drag to move it, or drag the corner handle to resize it.

## Good to know

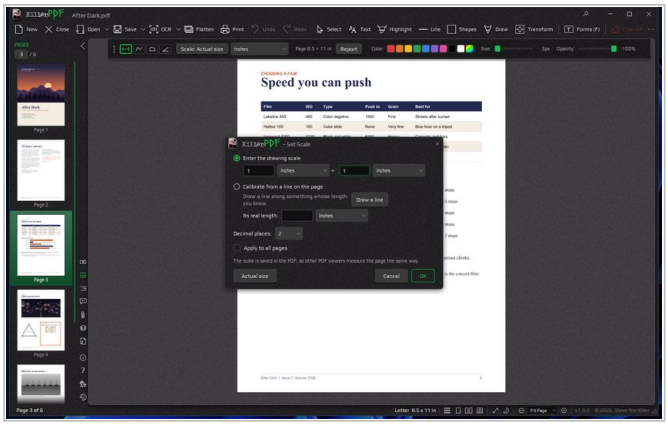
- Import accepts png, jpg, jpeg, bmp, gif, tiff and tif.
- A large image is shrunk to fit within half the page's longest side. A small one is not enlarged.
- Ctrl+V pastes a clipboard image onto the current page.
- Add Image is also in the page right-click menu.
- Watermarks and signatures use the same image library.

# Measure

Measure distances, outlines, areas and angles on a page, at the scale of the drawing.




*Distance and area measurements with the measure bar.*




*The Set Scale dialog.*

## How to use it

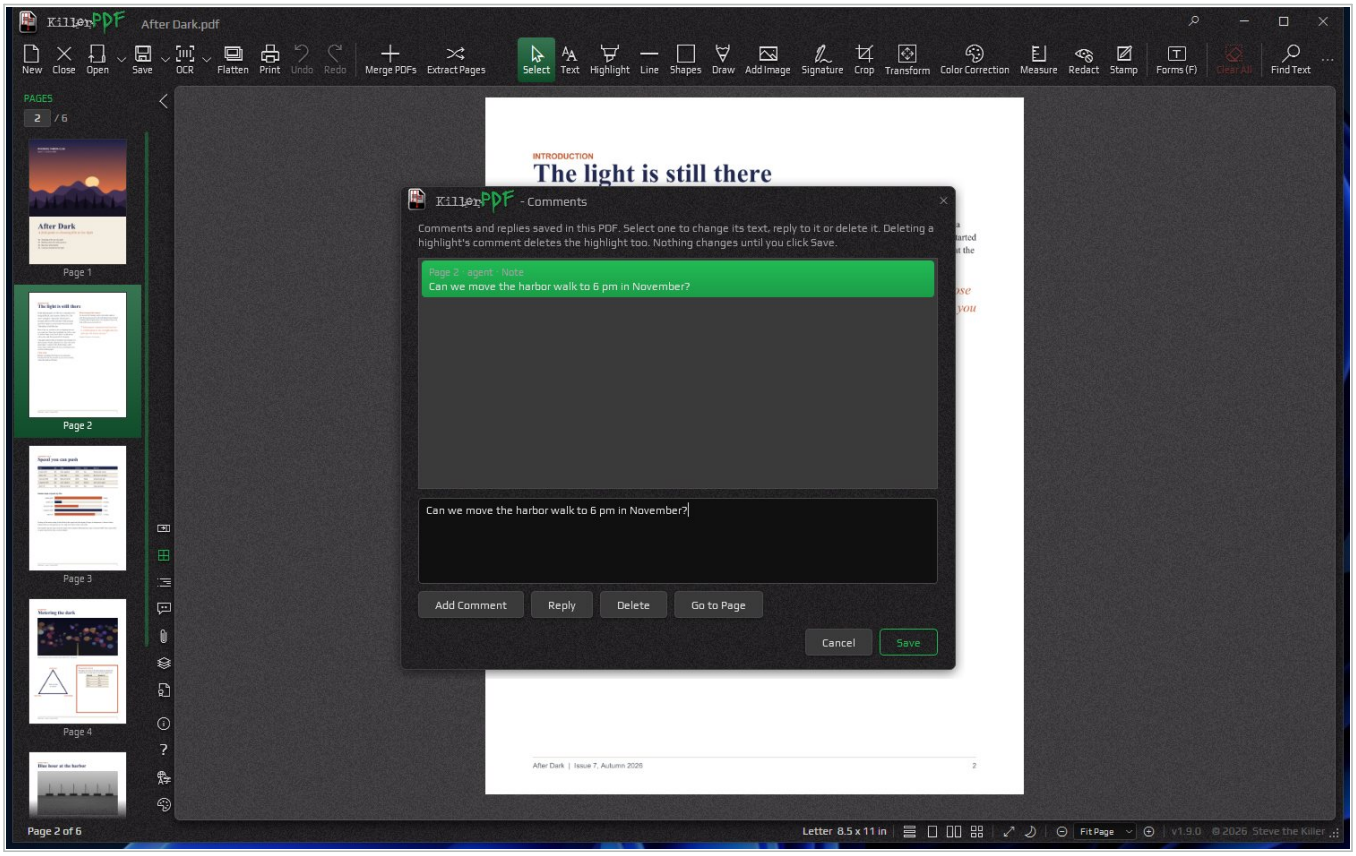
1. Press M, then pick a type. Shift+M steps to the next type.
2. Click the Scale button on the Measure bar (Alt+Shift+5) to open the Set Scale dialog.
3. Enter the drawing scale, or draw a line of known length and calibrate from it.
4. Pick a unit from the drop-down.
5. Measure. Backspace removes the last point and Esc cancels.
6. Click Report for every measurement, page by page.

| Type | How you finish |
|---|---|
| **Distance** | Click two points, or drag |
| **Perimeter** | Click each corner, then double-click, press Enter or click the first point |
| **Area** | Click each corner, then click the first point or press Enter |
| **Angle** | Click one arm, the corner, then the other arm |

- Points snap to the drawing's corners, lines and other measurements. Hold Alt to turn snapping off. Hold Shift for 45 degree steps.
- Nine units, from Inches to Kilometers.
- The report can be copied or saved as CSV or JSON.

# Comments

Review comments and replies live in the Comments panel and the Comments dialog, including ones made in other readers.




*The Comments dialog with a reply.*

## How to use it

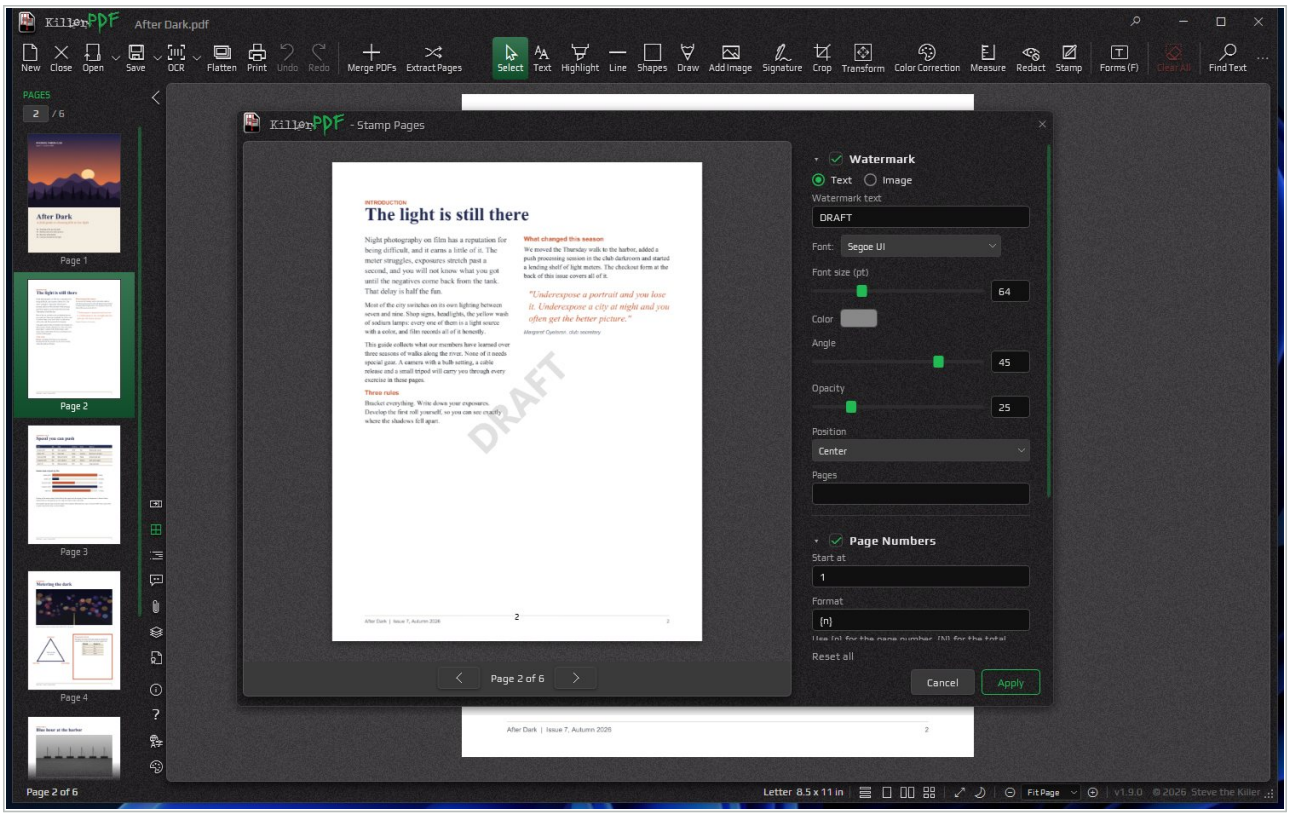
1. Press Alt+3 to open the Comments panel. Comments are grouped by page, with replies under their parent.
2. Use the All, Comments and Measurements chips to filter.
3. Click a row to jump to its page.
4. Double-click a row, or press Ctrl+Shift+D then K, to open the Comments dialog.
5. Edit the text, click Reply, Delete or Go to Page, or click Add Comment for a new note on the current page.
6. Save. Nothing is written until you do.

## Good to know

- The author name is your Windows user name.
- A comment without a name in the file cannot take replies.
- Deleting a comment on a highlight deletes the highlight too.
- From the command line, killerpdf comments lists them.

# Stamp Pages

Add page numbers, a watermark, or both, with a live preview before anything is applied.




*Stamp Pages with page numbers and a watermark in the preview.*

## How to use it

1. Press S or click Stamp on the toolbar.
2. For page numbers, set Start at and Format. Use {n} for the current page and {N} for the total, as in Page {n} of {N}.
3. For a watermark, choose Text or Image.
4. Pick a position, or drag on the preview for a custom spot.
5. Set a page range such as 1-3,5. Leave it empty for all pages.
6. Step through the pages in the preview, then apply.

| Option | Range |
|---|---|
| **Page number size** | 6 to 96 pt |
| **Watermark text size** | 12 to 200 pt, default DRAFT |
| **Watermark image scale** | 10 to 200 percent |
| **Watermark opacity** | 5 to 100 percent |
| **Watermark angle** | -90 to 90 degrees |
| **Positions** | Bottom Center, Bottom Right, Bottom Left, Top Center, Top Right, Top Left, Center, Custom |

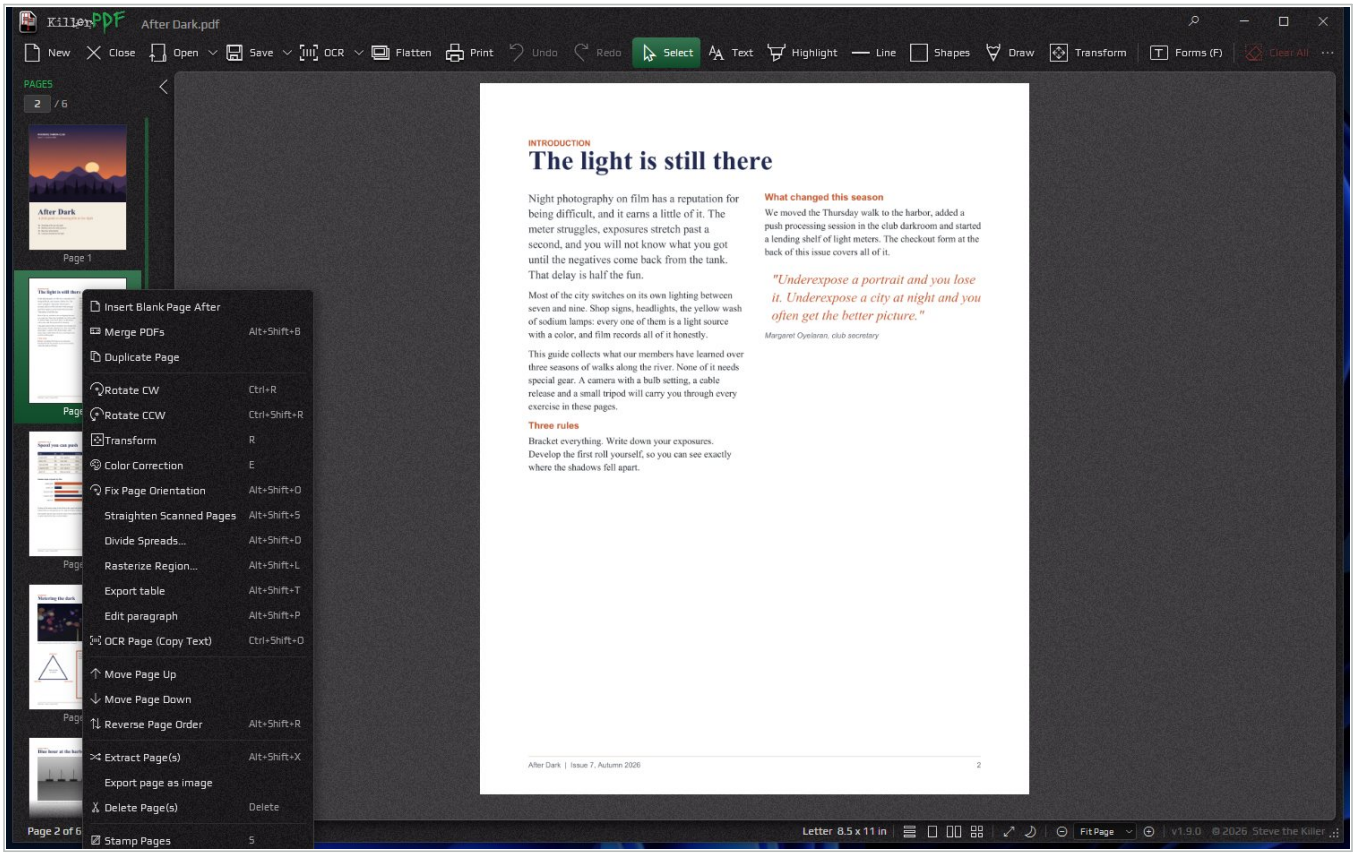
- Mirror on facing pages (outer edge) swaps sides on alternate pages.
- Reopen the tool, or double-click a placed stamp, to edit it. Turning both sections off removes the stamps.
- For Bates numbers or headers and footers, use killerpdf bates and number-pages.

# Pages and documents

- Organize, crop and transform pages
- Scan, OCR and reduce file size
- Export, structure and print

# The Pages panel

The Pages panel shows a thumbnail of every page. Most page work starts here, and each operation is one undo step.




*The right-click menu on a page thumbnail.*

### Rearrange your pages

1. Press Alt+1 to open the Pages panel.
2. Click a thumbnail to select it. Ctrl-click or Shift-click to add more, or drag a box around several.
3. Drag the selection to a new spot. A line shows where the pages will land.
4. Right-click a thumbnail and choose Rotate CW, Duplicate Page or Insert Blank Page After.
5. Press Del to delete the selected pages, then confirm.
6. To copy pages into another document, press F10 for a split view and drag the thumbnails across.
7. Drop PDF or image files on the list to insert them at the line.

### Good to know

- Rotate CW is Ctrl+R and Rotate CCW is Ctrl+Shift+R.
- Add Blank Page (Alt+Shift+A) offers Current page, Letter, A4, Legal or Custom, from 0.1 to 200 inches.
- Delete will not remove the last remaining page.
- Annotations and rotations travel with pages dragged to the other pane.
- A file opened read-only because of owner restrictions refuses page edits until you unlock it.

# Merge, extract, split and reorder

Put documents together, pull pages out, or cut a file apart. Merge and extract live on the toolbar. Split is a command line feature.

### Combine and pull apart

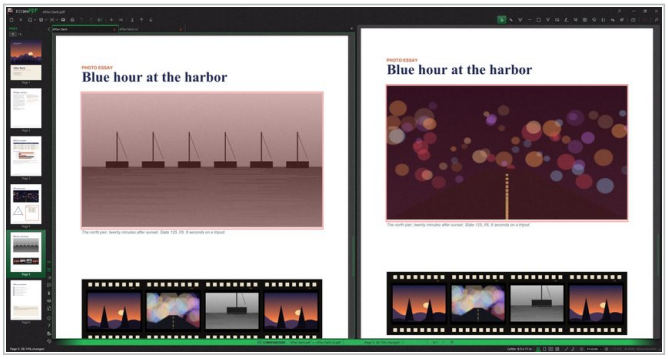
1. Click Merge PDFs on the toolbar (Alt+Shift+B) and pick one or more PDFs. Their pages go on the end.
2. To insert in the middle, right-click a thumbnail and choose Merge PDFs. The pages go after that one.
3. To merge images, drop JPG, PNG, BMP, GIF or TIFF files on the window and choose Merge into one PDF.
4. To extract, press Alt+Shift+X, type a range such as 1-3,5,9-12, and save the new PDF.
5. To reverse the order, press Alt+Shift+R. With two or more pages selected, only those reverse.
6. To number pages with letters or roman numerals, press Ctrl+Shift+D, then G, and edit the page label ranges.

### Good to know

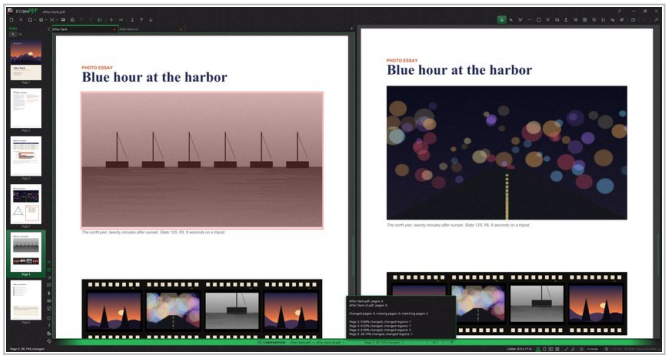
- A drop takes at most 50 files, after a confirmation. Folders and ZIP archives work too.
- A damaged file triggers an offer to repair a copy first. The original is never written.
- Page label styles: Decimal, Uppercase Roman, Lowercase Roman, Uppercase letters, Lowercase letters, Prefix only.
- Split runs from the command line with killerpdf split: one PDF per page by default, or every N pages, N equal parts, at bookmarks, or by maximum size. Use one rule at a time.

# Compare two PDFs

Compare puts two versions side by side, keeps them scrolled and zoomed together, and outlines what changed on each page.




*Two issues of the club guide compared on page 5, with the changed photo outlined on both sides.*




*The report lists the changed share and the changed regions for every page.*

## How to compare

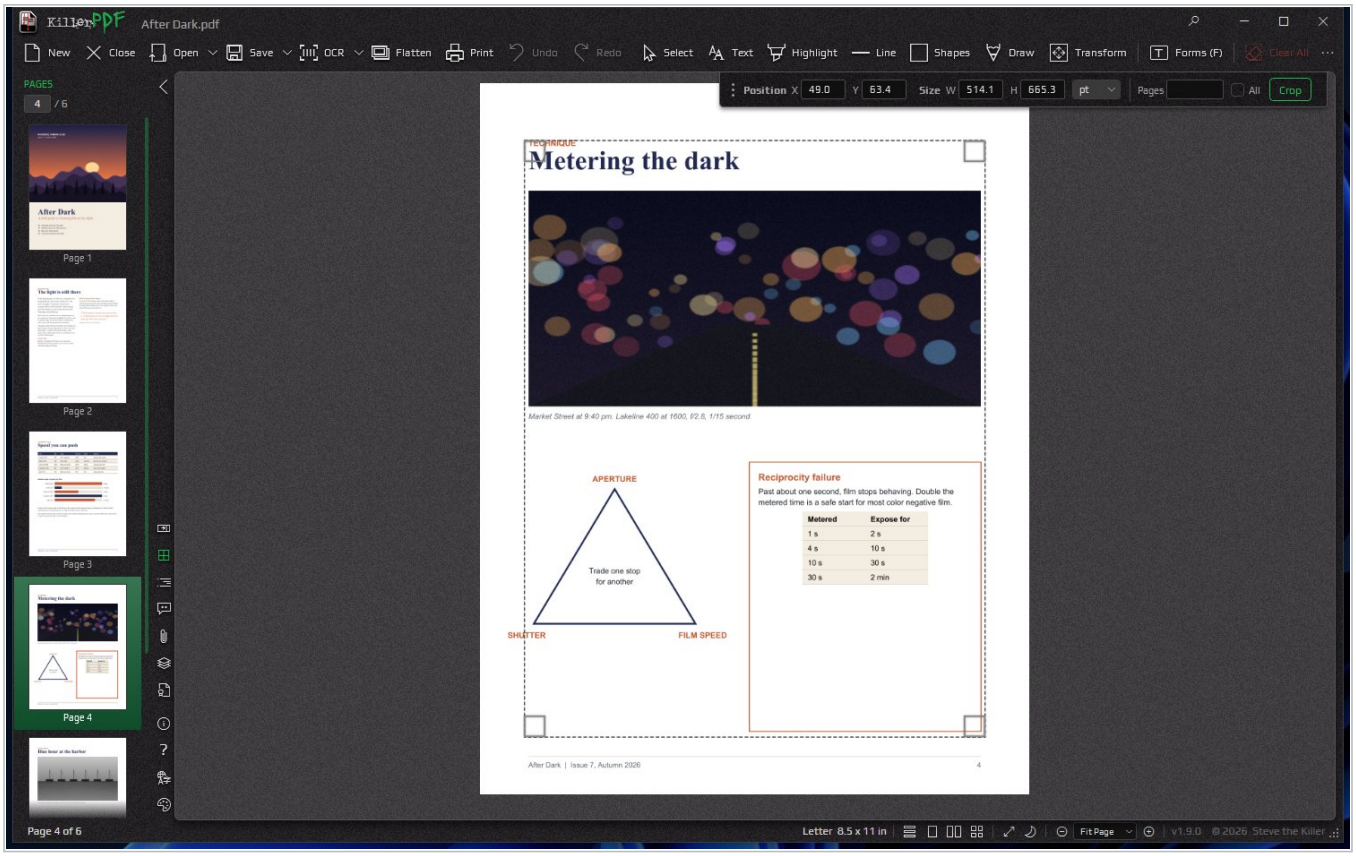
1. Open the first PDF.
2. Click Compare PDFs on the toolbar or press Alt+Shift+V.
3. Pick another open tab, or choose Choose another PDF to pick a file.
4. Scroll or zoom either side. The other side follows.
5. Use the arrows on the comparison bar to step through the changed regions on the page.
6. Click the page result on the bar for a report on every page.
7. Press Escape or click Compare PDFs again to end the comparison.

## Good to know

- The comparison opens on the page you were reading.
- Changes are found by comparing the rendered pages, so a moved photo or a recolored chart shows up even when the text is identical.
- A page that exists in only one PDF is named on the bar and in the report.
- Pages of different sizes are reported as dimensions that differ.

# Crop

Crop sets the visible area of a page. Drag the rectangle, or type exact values.




*The crop rectangle on a page with the crop bar.*

## Crop pages

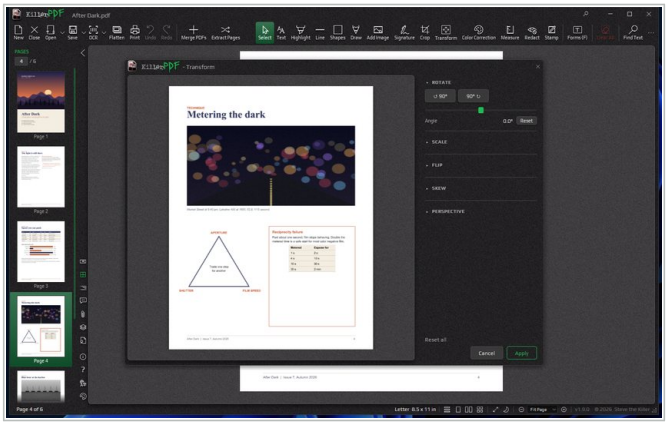
1. Press C or click Crop on the toolbar. A rectangle appears inset 8% from every edge.
2. Drag the rectangle, or type X, Y, W and H. Choose points, inches or percent. The origin is the top left.
3. To crop more pages, type a range such as 1-3,5 in the Pages box, or tick All. Blank means the current page.
4. Press Enter or click Crop to apply. Press Esc to cancel.

## Good to know

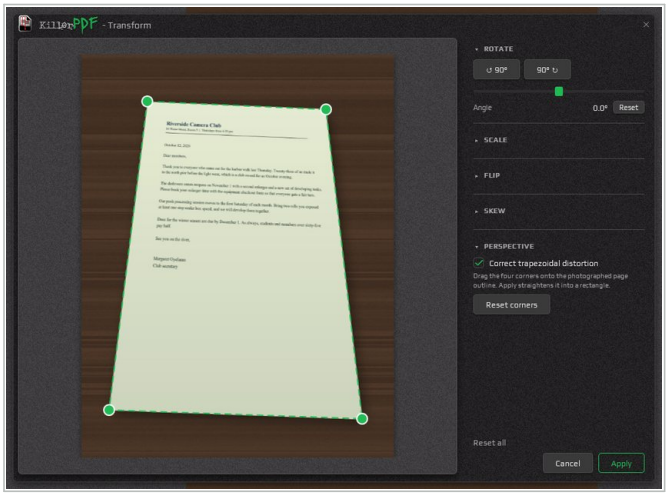
- Pages of different sizes are scaled proportionally, and each crop stays inside the page.
- A crop hides the outside area. It does not delete it, so use Redact for anything that must be gone.
- Crop is not available on the command line or as a macro step.

# Transform and perspective

Transform rotates, scales, flips, straightens and levels a page with a live preview. Perspective fixes pages photographed at an angle.



*The Transform window with its sections.*




*Corner handles dragged onto a letter photographed at an angle.*

## Fix a page

1. Press R or click Transform. Closing the window without Apply changes nothing.
2. Rotate with the 90 degree buttons or the slider.
3. For a crooked scan, choose Draw a level line and drag along something that should be level, like a line of text.
4. For a photographed page, turn on Correct trapezoidal distortion and drag the four corners onto the page outline.
5. Adjust scale, flip, levels and page quality, and watch the preview.
6. Click Apply.

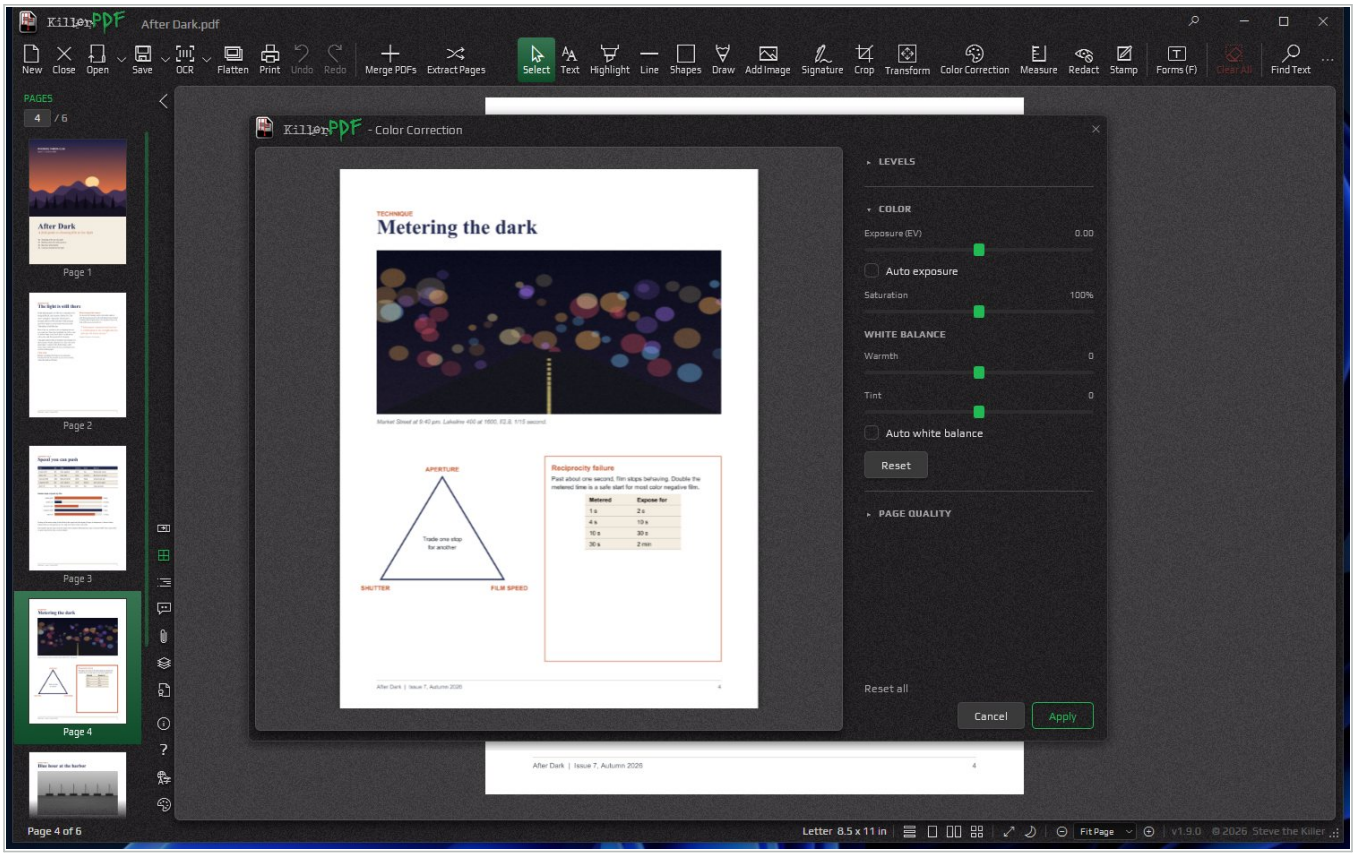
## Ranges

| Control | Range |
|---|---|
| **Rotate slider** | -45 to +45 degrees, 0.1 steps |
| **Scale** | 25% to 200% |
| **Black point** | 0 to 200 |
| **White point** | 55 to 255 |
| **Midtones** | 0.2 to 2.5 |
| **Output resolution** | 72 to 600 DPI |
| **JPEG quality** | 25% to 100% |

**Tip.** Transform rasterizes each page, so selectable text is lost. A batch of pages is one undo step.

# Color correction

Color correction fixes exposure and white balance on pages that came out dark, flat or tinted.




*The Color correction tool with its sliders.*

### Correct a page

1. Select the pages in the Pages panel.
2. Press E, or right-click and choose Color Correction.
3. Move Exposure, Saturation, Warmth and Tint, or use the Auto options for exposure and white balance.
4. Check the preview. Reset puts a section back to normal.
5. Click Apply.

### Ranges

| Control | Range |
|---|---|
| **Exposure** | -3 to +3 EV |
| **Saturation** | 0 to 200% |
| **Warmth** | -100 to +100 |
| **Tint** | -100 to +100 |

> **Tip.** Color correction shares its window with Transform and rasterizes the page, so selectable text is lost.

# Scanning and scan cleanup

Scan straight into KillerPDF, then clean the pages up. Fix tilt, turn pages upright and split two-page spreads.

### Scan and clean up

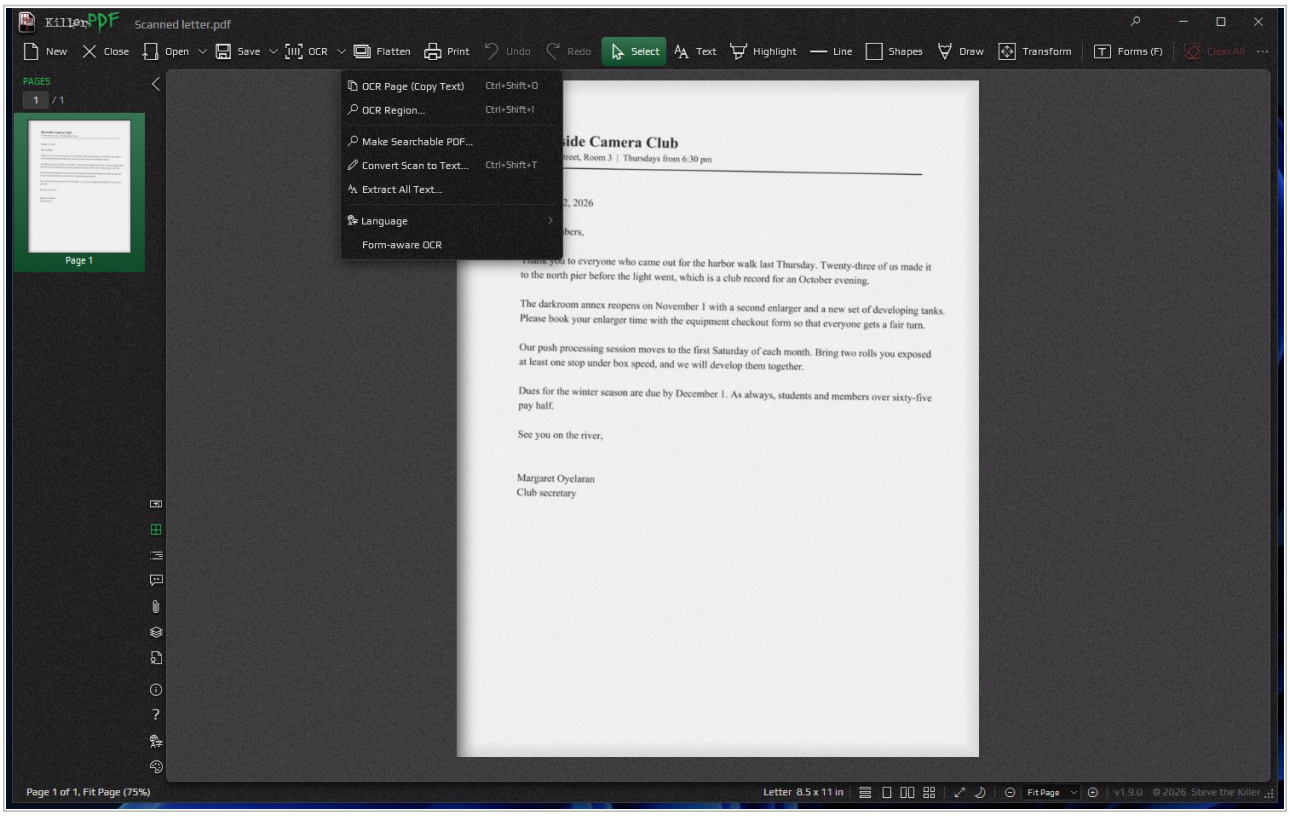
1. Click the arrow beside Open and choose Scan...
2. Pick your scanner. You can show its own settings window for color, resolution and pages.
3. Scan. The pages open as a new, unsaved PDF.
4. Press Alt+Shift+S to straighten tilted scans.
5. Press Alt+Shift+O to turn pages upright.
6. Press Alt+Shift+D to divide two-page spreads.
7. To give a PDF a scanned look, press Alt+Shift+F and tick the Scanned look effects.

### Good to know

- Scanning needs the 64-bit TWAIN manager (TWAINDSM.dll), which scanner drivers install.
- Straighten changes only scans without a text layer and ignores tilt under 0.15 degrees. Run it before OCR.
- Fix Page Orientation reads text direction. On scans it uses OCR, so it may offer to download a language model.
- Divide Spreads: Left and right pages or Top and bottom pages, divider between 5% and 95%, for this page, selected pages or all pages.
- Scanned look effects: tilt, warm paper tone, scanner grain, soft focus, edge shadow.

# OCR

OCR reads the text in a scan. You can copy it, add a hidden text layer so the scan becomes searchable, or turn the scan into real text.




*The OCR drop-down with the language list.*

### Make a scan searchable

1. Click the arrow on the OCR button to open the OCR menu.
2. Open Language and tick one or more. At least one stays ticked.
3. Choose Make Searchable PDF... KillerPDF suggests the file name name-searchable.pdf and adds an invisible text layer. Esc cancels.
4. Or choose Convert Scan to Text... (Ctrl+Shift+T) to replace scanned words with real text.
5. In Review Converted Words, check each word as scanned beside its text version. Clear a word to keep it as a scan.
6. Click Save Converted PDF.

### Languages and models

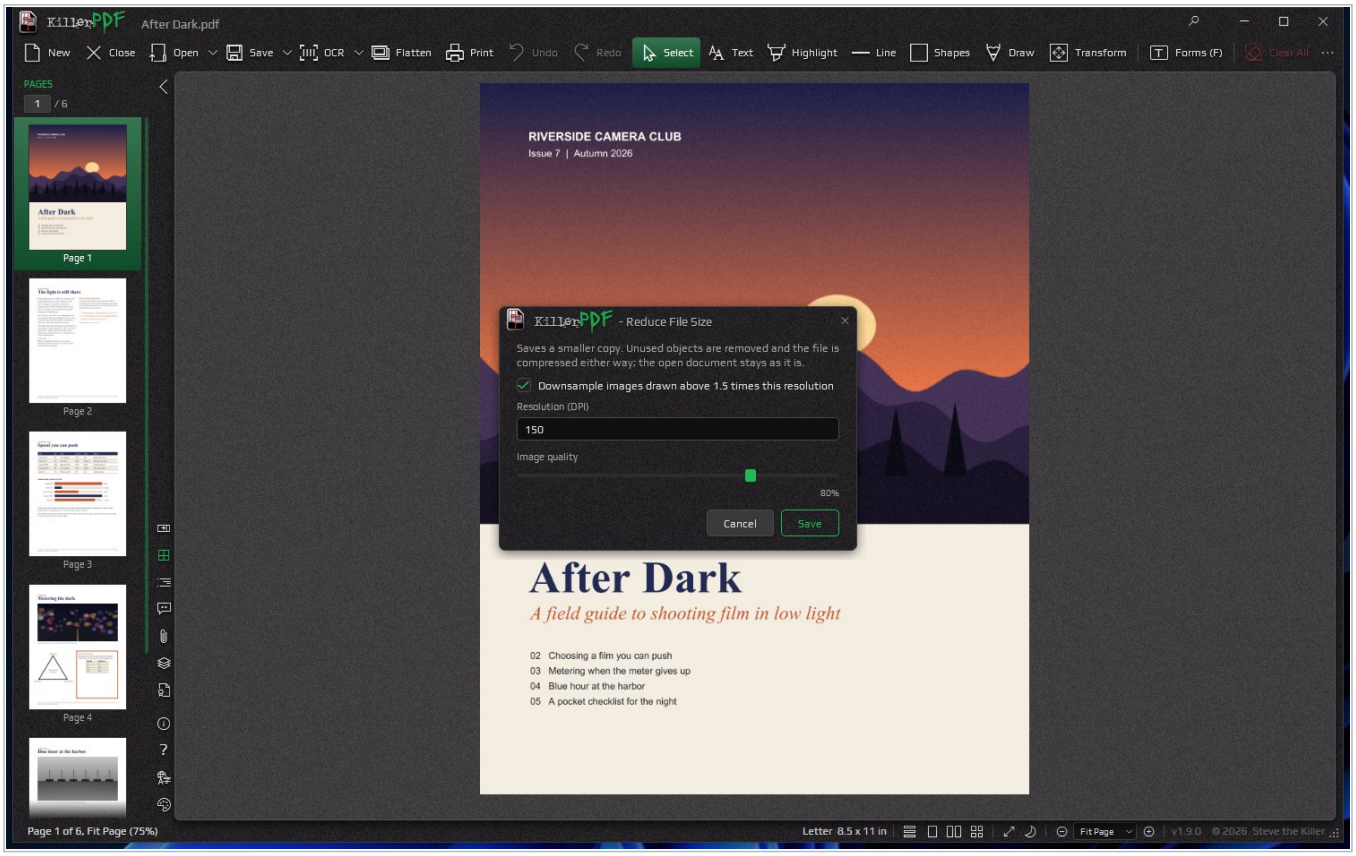
English, Bengali, Czech, German, Spanish, French, Hungarian, Italian, Japanese, Kazakh, Norwegian, Polish, Portuguese, Russian, Slovenian, Turkish, Ukrainian, Vietnamese, Chinese (Simplified) and Chinese (Traditional). No model ships in the program, English included. KillerPDF asks before the first download, and Use High Quality Models switches to the larger set.

### Also in the menu

- OCR Page (Copy Text) is Ctrl+Shift+O. OCR Region is Ctrl+Shift+I.
- Extract All Text saves a .txt or .md file.
- On the command line, killerpdf scan-to-text can also write a review folder.

# Reduce file size

Reduce File Size saves a smaller copy and leaves your open document alone.




*The Reduce File Size options.*

### Shrink a file

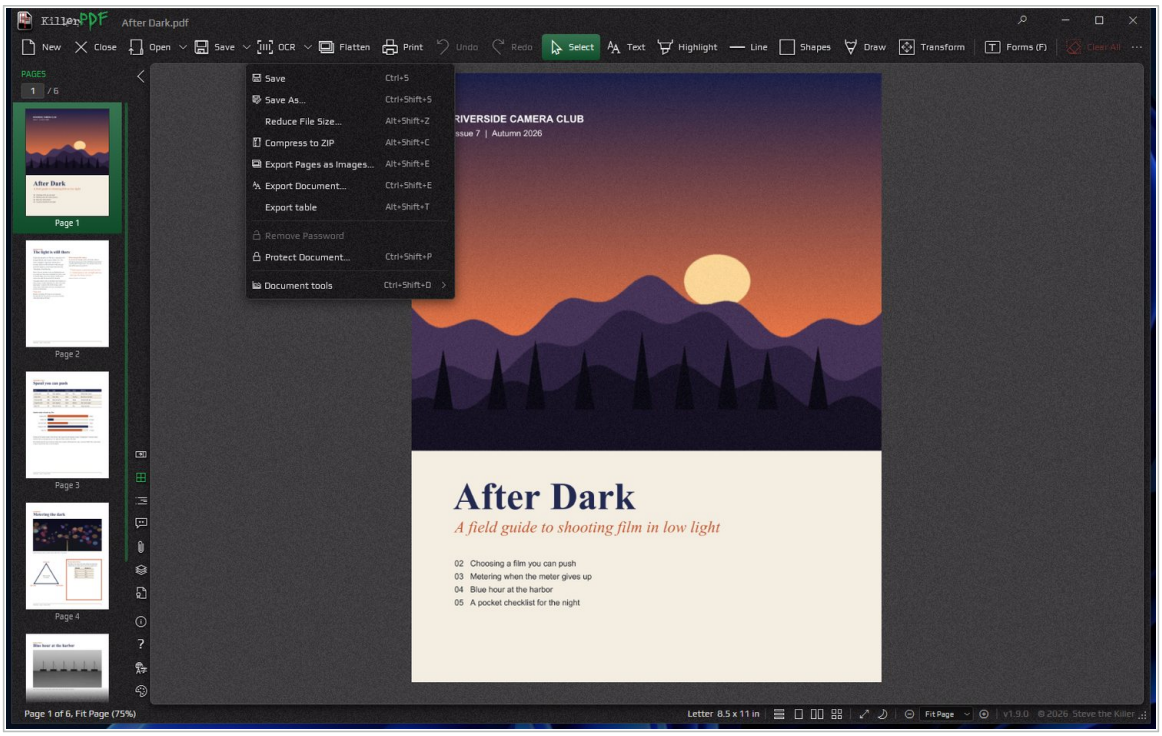
1. Click the arrow beside Save and choose Reduce File Size... (Alt+Shift+Z).
2. Unused objects are removed and the file is compressed in every case.
3. To shrink images, tick the downsample option. Set a DPI from 36 to 1200 (default 150).
4. Set image quality from 25% to 100% (default 80%).
5. Click Save and choose a name. The status line shows the size before and after, and how many images were resampled.

### Good to know

- Images are downsampled only when drawn above 1.5 times the DPI you set.
- On the command line, killerpdf optimize can also strip metadata, attachments, javascript, comments, thumbnails, bookmarks, forms, xfa, openaction and layers.
- A signed destination asks before replacing.
- Guided tasks include Prepare for email, which optimizes without reducing image quality.

# Export and conversion

Turn a PDF into other formats, or bring Word, Excel and image files in as PDFs.




*The export choices under the Save arrow.*

### Export a PDF

1. Click the arrow beside Save and choose Export Document... (Ctrl+Shift+E).
2. Pick a format.
3. Type a page range, or leave it blank for all pages.
4. For Word or PowerPoint, choose Editable content or Page pictures.
5. Read the list of export limitations if one appears, then save.

### Formats out

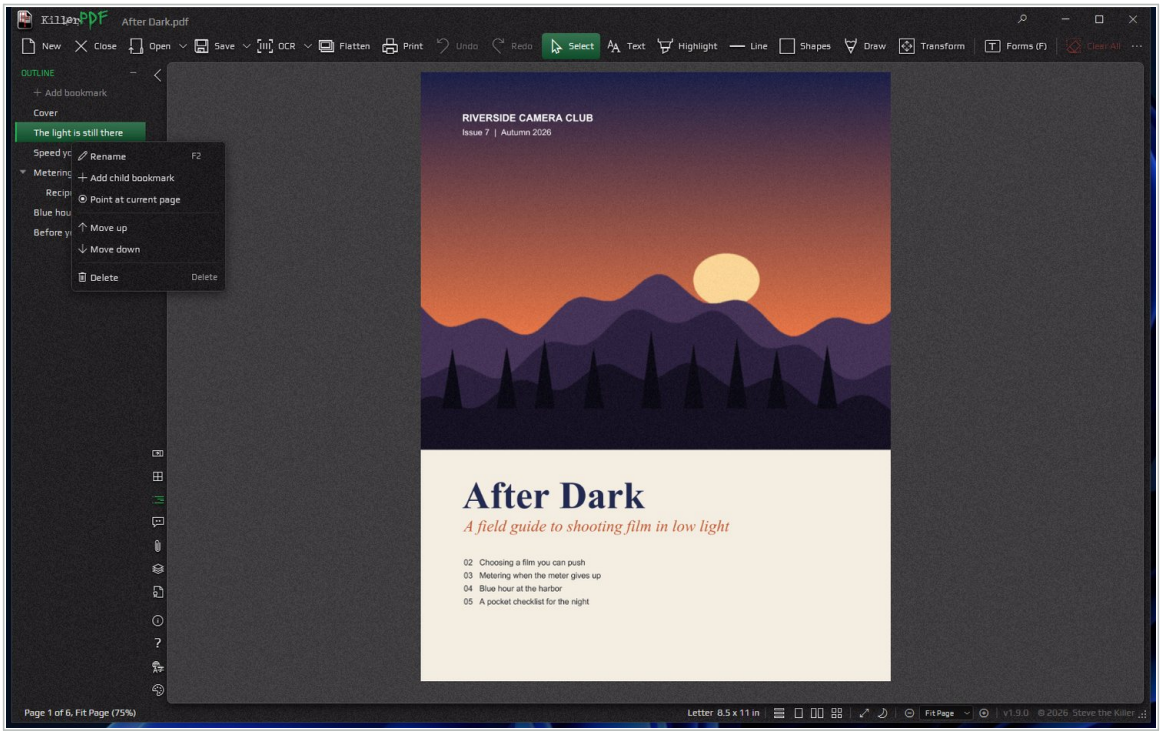
| Format | File |
|---|---|
| **Word** | .docx |
| **Excel** | .xlsx |
| **PowerPoint** | .pptx |
| **HTML** | .html |
| **Markdown** | .md |
| **Plain text** | .txt |
| **JSON** | .json |

### Also

- Export Pages as Images (Alt+Shift+E) writes PNG or JPEG at 24 to 1200 DPI, default 150.
- Export table (Alt+Shift+T) saves a table you box to XLSX or CSV.
- Convert Word or Excel file... under the Open arrow takes .docx, .doc, .xlsx and .xls. Old .doc and .xls files need Word or Excel installed.

# Bookmarks and document structure

Bookmarks, contents pages, page labels, attachments and layers make a long document easier to move through.




*Editing bookmarks in the Outline panel.*

### Build bookmarks and contents

1. Press Alt+2 for the Outline panel. Add, rename (F2), move and drag bookmarks.
2. For a quick start, press Ctrl+Shift+D, then B, to create bookmarks from headings.
3. Set minimum heading size (default 14 points) and depth (default 6).
4. Tick the proposals you want, edit titles and levels, and click Add selected.
5. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then I, to insert a clickable table of contents at the front.

### Document tools (Ctrl+Shift+D, then the letter)

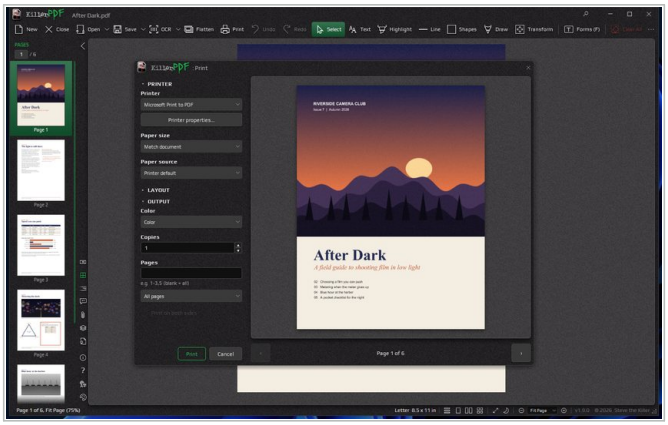
| Letter | Tool |
|---|---|
| **G** | Edit page labels |
| **V** | Initial view settings |
| **T** | Edit attachments |
| **O** | Edit portfolio |
| **E** | Edit layers |
| **N** | Navigation audit |

### Good to know

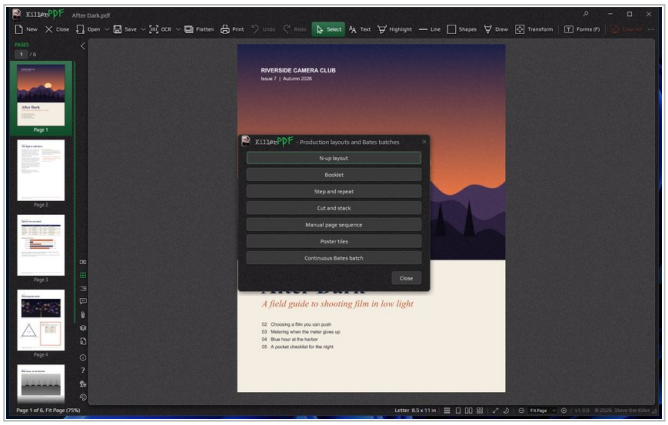
- The contents page is built from bookmarks, 40 entries per page, so add them first.
- Layers are shown and hidden in the Layers panel (Alt+5). Locked layers cannot be toggled.
- Attachments are in the Attachments panel (Alt+4).

# Printing and production layouts

Print from a preview window, or lay pages out for booklets, sheets and numbered batches.




*The print window with the page preview.*




*Production layouts and Bates batches.*

### Print a document

1. Press Ctrl+P.
2. Pick the printer, paper size and orientation.
3. Choose Scale, Margins and Pages per sheet.
4. Set Copies, a page range, and odd or even pages.
5. Click Print when the preview finishes.

### Print limits

- Pages per sheet: 1, 2, 4, 6 or 9. Copies: 1 to 9999. Custom scale: 1% to 1000%.
- Final pages are rendered at 300 DPI before spooling.

### Production layouts (Ctrl+Shift+D, then O)

| Layout |
|---|
| **N-up layout** |
| **Booklet** |
| **Step and repeat** |
| **Cut and stack** |
| **Manual page sequence** |
| **Poster tiles** |
| **Continuous Bates batch** |

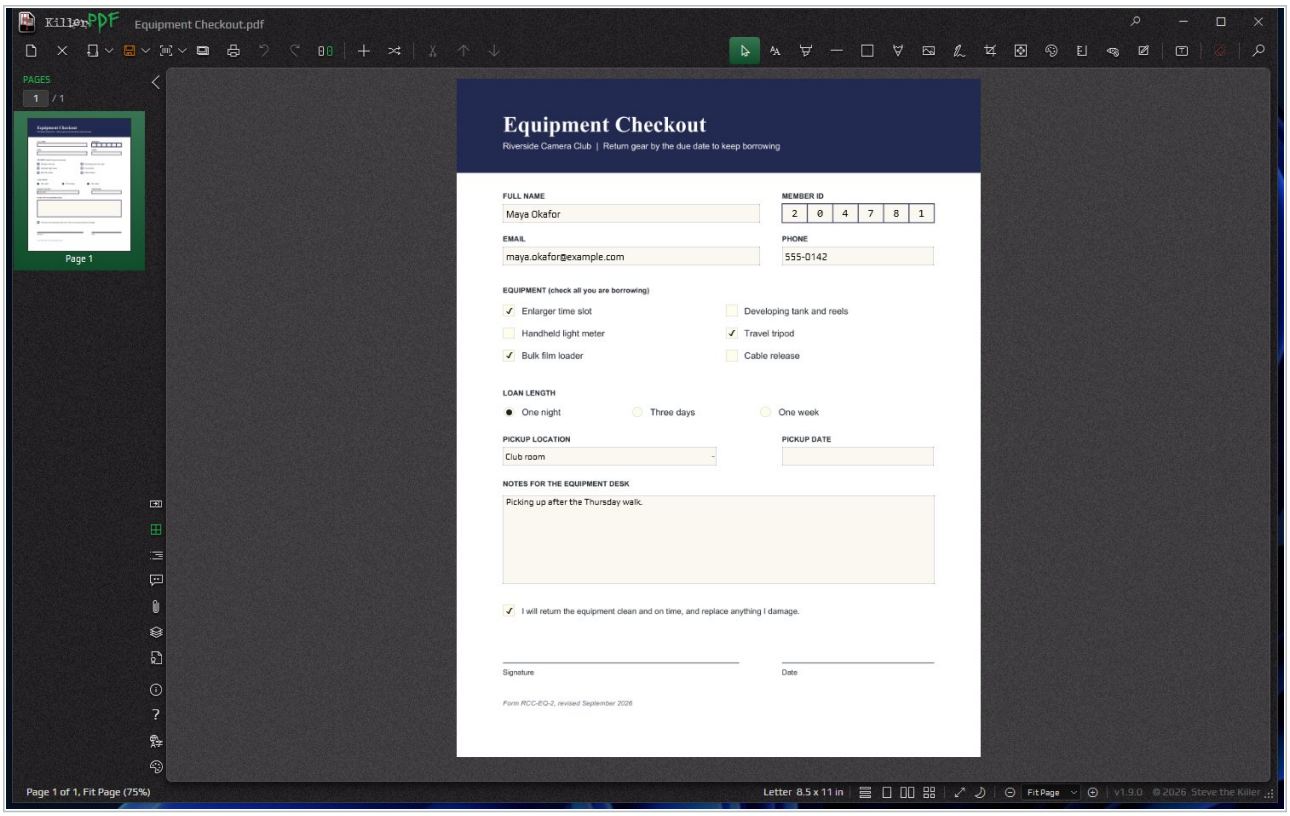
IV

# Forms and signatures

- Fill and create forms
- Form data and Data Merge
- Visual and digital signatures

# Filling forms

Open a fillable PDF and double-click into the fields. You do not need a special tool.




*The checkout form being filled in.*

### How to fill a form

1. Open the PDF.
2. Double-click a text field and type. Tab moves to the next field.
3. Pick from drop-downs and list boxes.
4. Tick check boxes and radio buttons.
5. Click a signature or initials field to place a saved visual signature.
6. Save.

### Field types you can fill

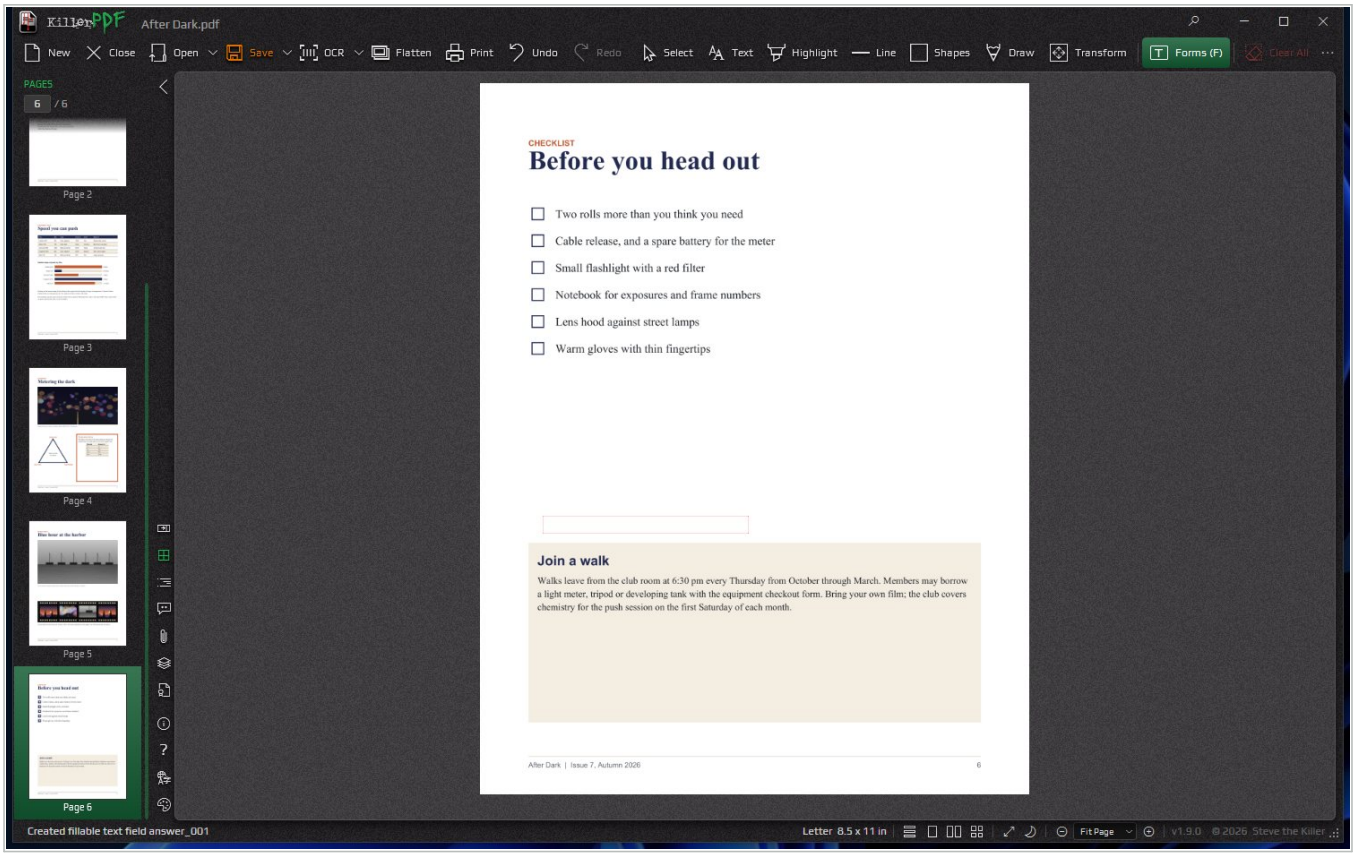
- Text: single line, multiline, comb and password.
- Drop-down and multi-select list box.
- Check box and radio buttons.
- Signature and initials fields. These are visual marks, not digital signatures.
- Read-only fields are disabled and push buttons are skipped.
- Calculated fields update when you commit a value. Unsupported scripts are not run.
- With the Select tool, a single click on a text field selects it so it can be moved; a double-click edits it.

### Restricted forms

If the owner blocks editing but allows form filling, you can fill the form and save it. The file keeps its encryption and permissions. This works only when you have added no drawn markup, stamps or redaction marks. Anything else needs the owner password, through the Enter Owner Password button.

# Creating form fields

Turn a flat page into a fillable form by drawing fields, or let KillerPDF find the fields for you.




*Placing a new text field with the Forms tool.*

## Add fields

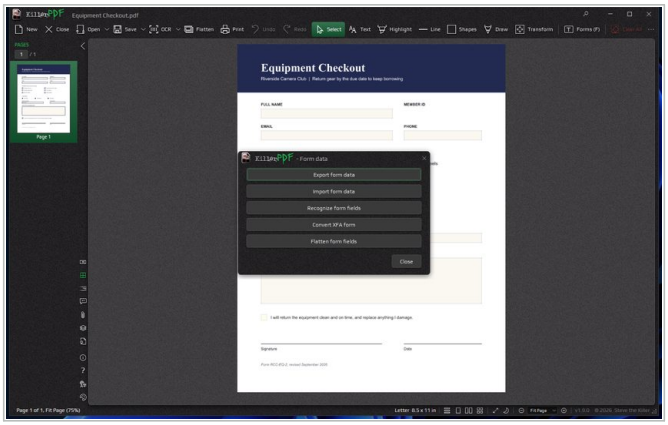
1. Press F or click Forms on the toolbar.
2. Drag a rectangle on the page to make a text field.
3. Drag a field to move it. Drag the corner grip to resize it. Press Delete to remove it.
4. Right-click a field for Fill Color or Save as Field Preset.
5. To let KillerPDF find fields, press Ctrl+Shift+D, then H, then choose Recognize form fields.
6. Tick the fields to add, rename them if you like, and confirm.

## Good to know

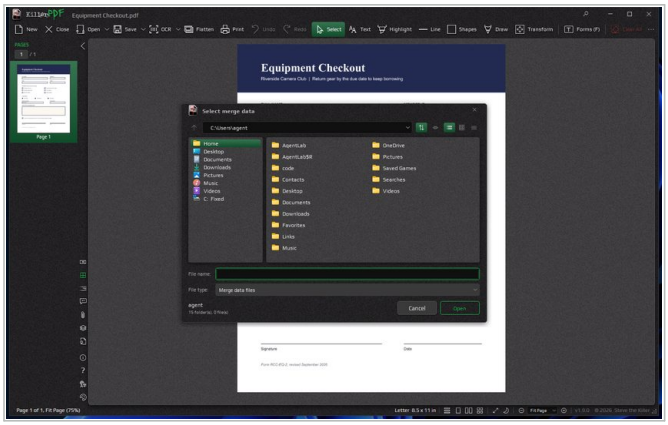
- You can create text fields and check boxes. Radio groups, drop-downs and list boxes can be filled but not created.
- Recognition looks for stroked rectangles on the page, from 8 to 60 points tall. Small squares become check boxes.
- A new field is named answer_001, answer_002 and so on, and is multiline when it is tall enough.
- A preset keeps size, font size, colors and border, and works in any document.
- Convert XFA form is in the same menu.

# Form data and Data Merge

Move answers in and out of a form, or fill one template once per row of a data file.




*The Form data window.*




*The Data merge window.*

### Form data (Ctrl+Shift+D, then H)

| Direction | Formats |
|---|---|
| **Export form data** | XFDF (default), FDF or JSON |
| **Import form data** | FDF or XFDF |

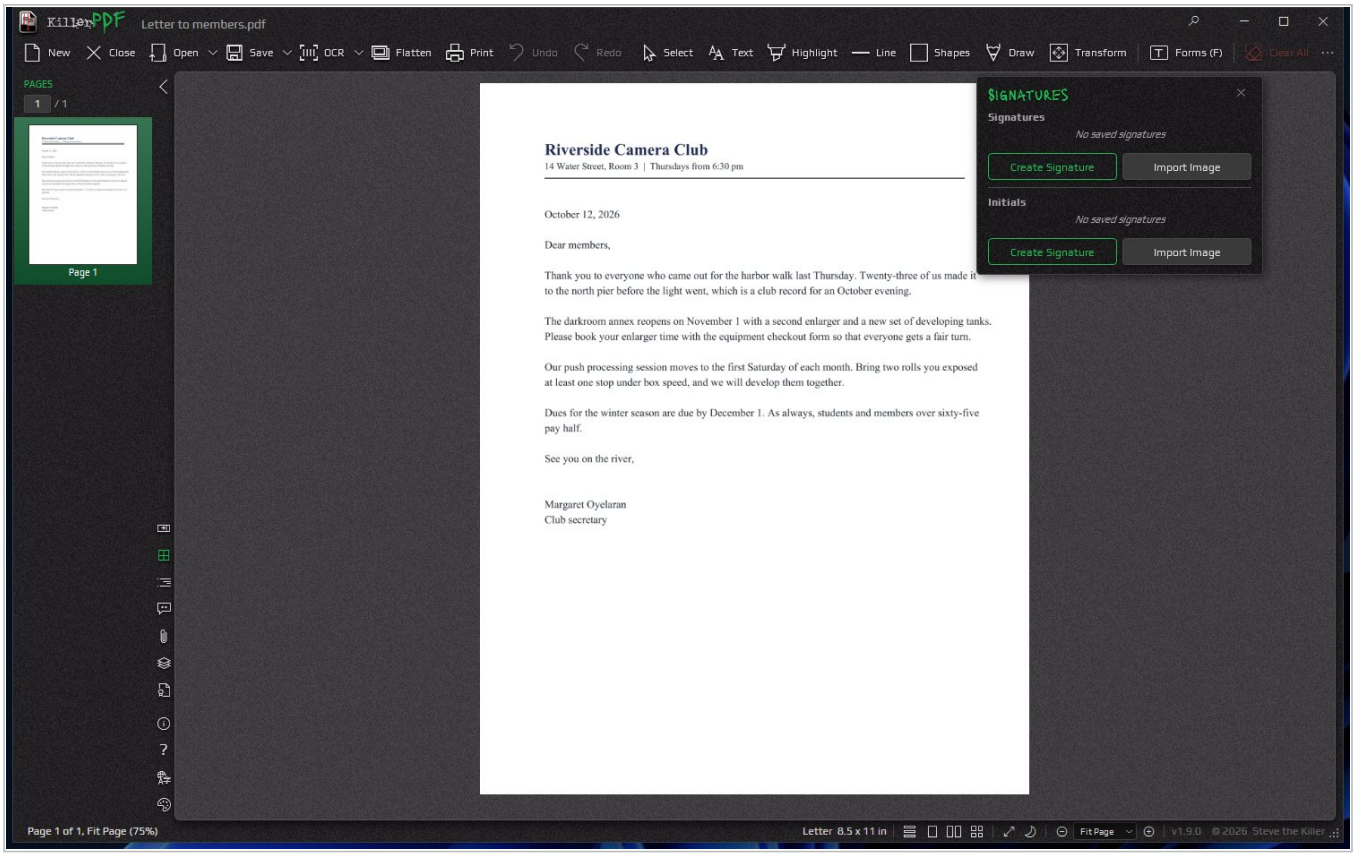
### Merge a template with a data file

1. Open the form that will be the template.
2. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then D.
3. Pick a CSV, JSON or XLSX file.
4. Name the first output file.
5. Check the mapping. Columns match fields with the same name, ignoring case. Add or change mappings if needed.
6. Review and run. A report shows how many records succeeded and failed.

- Import shows a preview of matching and skipped fields and can flatten after importing.
- CSV is for Data Merge only, not form data.
- You get one PDF per record, editable or flattened.
- Mappings save as a JSON profile.
- Page text can be filled with {{name}} placeholders through a Text placeholder mapping; every placeholder you map must be found in the page text.

# Visual signatures and initials

Draw or import your signature once, then place it on any document.




*Drawing a visual signature.*

### Create and place

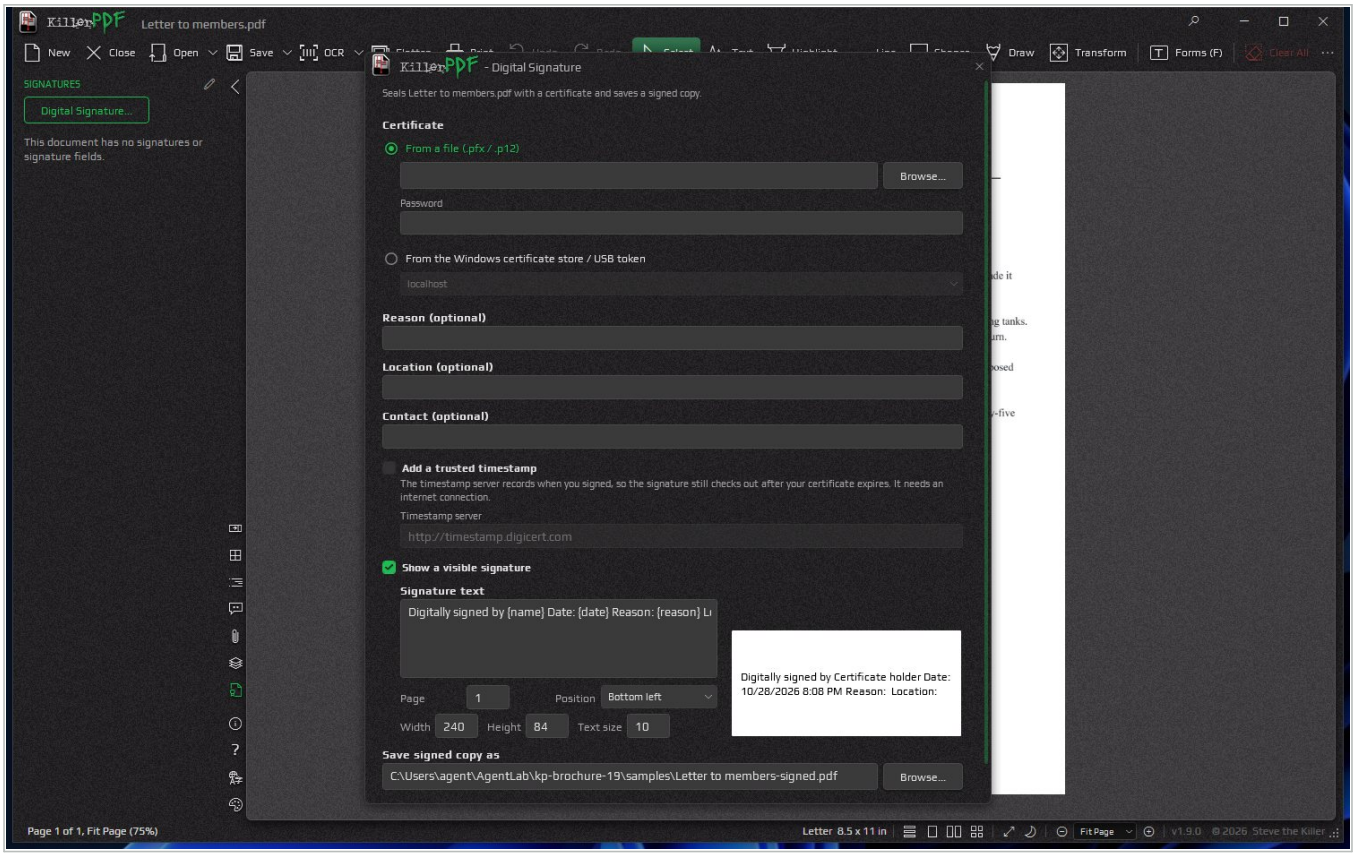
1. Press G or click Signature on the toolbar.
2. Click Create Signature.
3. Draw on the pad with a Thin, Medium or Thick pen, then click Save Signature. Clear starts over.
4. Or click Import Image and pick a png, jpg, jpeg, bmp, gif, tiff, tif or SVG file.
5. For a scan, drag the Sensitivity slider to remove the paper background.
6. Click the page to place it. Drag to move it and use the corner handle to resize it.

### Good to know

- Saved signatures and initials are kept for your user and reusable in any document.
- In a form, click a signature field and the saved choice fits into it. Click a signed field to Change or Remove it.
- SVG signatures stay vector.
- A visual signature is drawn into the page on save. It carries no certificate.

# Digital signatures

Sign with a certificate so anyone can check who signed and whether the file changed afterward.




*The Digital Signature window.*

### Sign a document

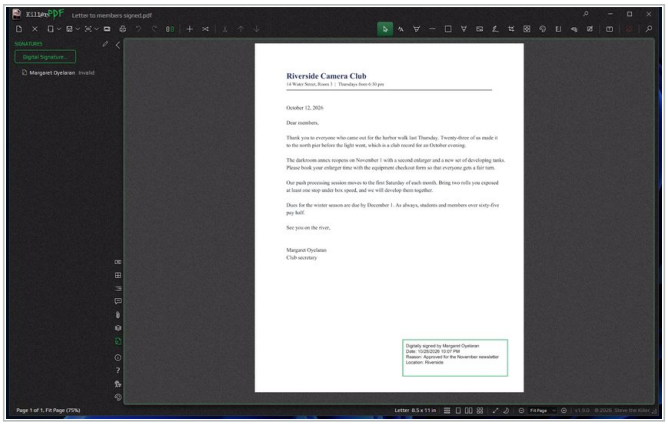
1. Press Ctrl+Shift+G, or open the Signatures panel (Alt+6) and click Digital Signature.
2. Choose a certificate: a .pfx or .p12 file with its password, or one from the Windows certificate store or a USB token.
3. Add a Reason, Location and Contact if you want them.
4. Tick Add a trusted timestamp to use the default server, http://timestamp.digicert.com.
5. Tick Show a visible signature to set its text, page, corner, width, height and text size.
6. Sign. The result is saved as a new copy.

### Good to know

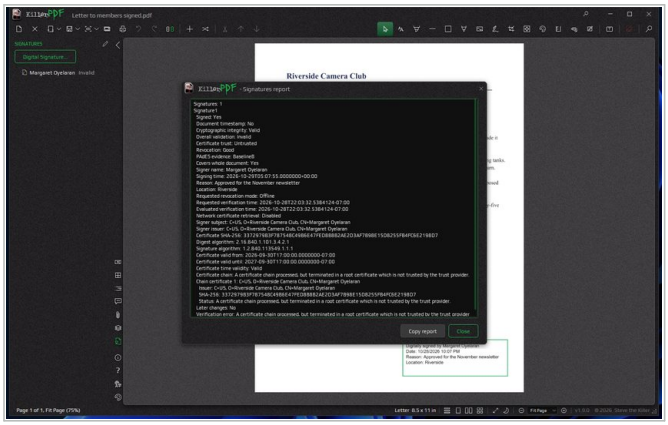
- KillerPDF creates approval signatures only, using SHA-256.
- A timestamp needs an internet connection. If it cannot be obtained, the document is not signed.
- Saving edits to a signed file removes the signature, and KillerPDF warns you first.
- Command line: killerpdf sign in.pdf out.pdf --pfx my.pfx --timestamp

# Checking signatures

KillerPDF checks every signature when you open a file and tells you how far it can vouch for it.



*The signed club letter with its visible signature and the Signatures panel (Alt+6).*



*The report for the club letter, signed with a self-signed test certificate: the math checks out, the signer is not trusted.*

### Signature status

| Status | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Valid** | Integrity, trust, certificate dates and revocation all pass. |
| **Invalid** | The structure or cryptography fails, the chain is untrusted, the certificate was not yet valid, or it was revoked. |
| **Not fully verified** | Nothing failed, but not every check could pass. |
| **Not signed** | A signature field with no signature. |

### Look closer

1. Press Alt+6 to open the Signatures panel.
2. Read each row's status. A row that says changed after signing has later edits.
3. Double-click a row, or press Ctrl+Shift+D then W, for the full report.
4. Press Ctrl+Shift+D then Z to open the Certificates window.

### Good to know

- An expired certificate alone does not make a signature Invalid.
- Trust comes from Windows plus roots you mark Trust as Root in KillerPDF. Revocation checks are offline.
- Certificates inside a PDF never become trusted by themselves.
- The Certificates window imports .cer, .crt and .pem files. No private keys.

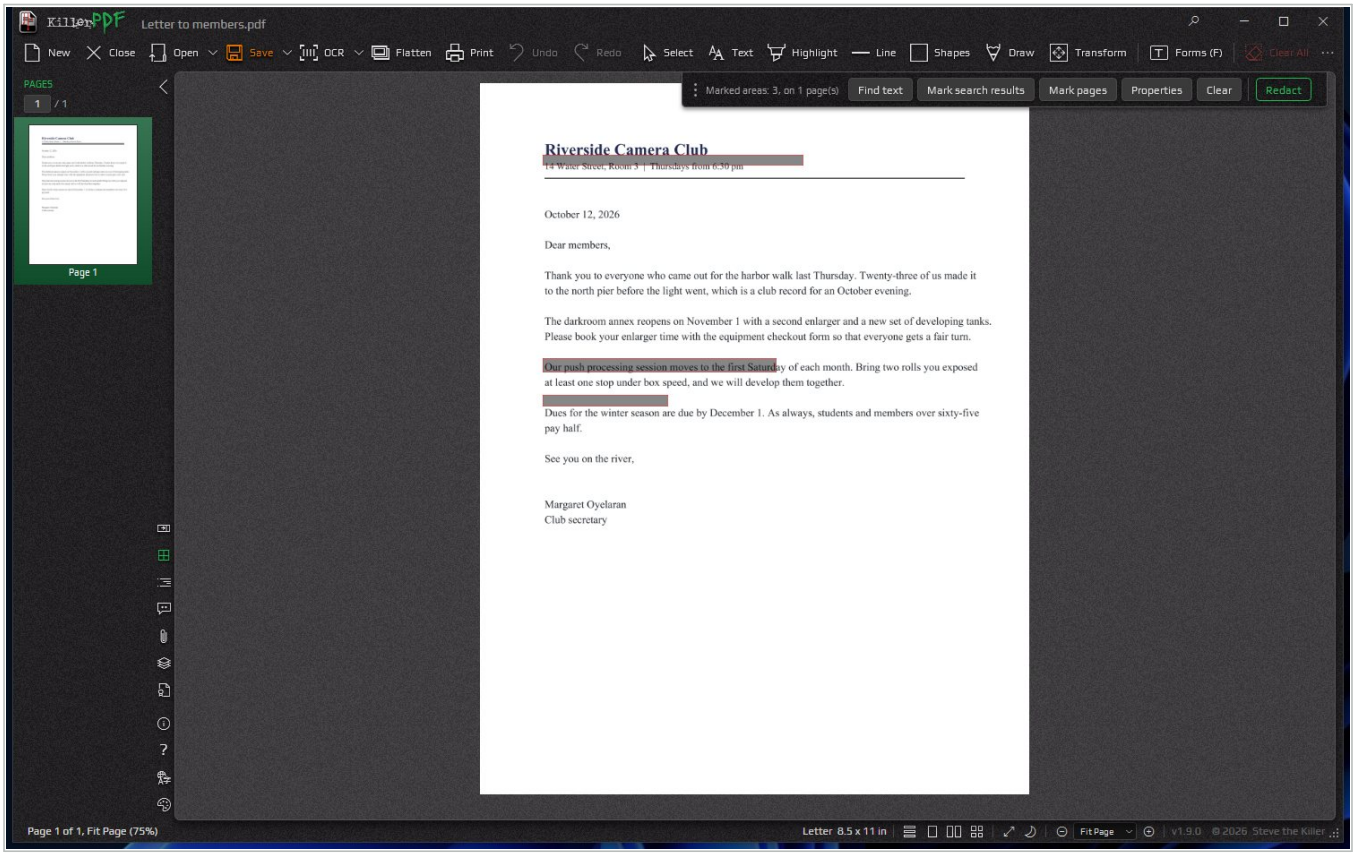
V

# Security

- Permanent redaction
- Passwords, permissions and certificates
- Preflight and accessibility reports

# Redaction: marking and applying

Redaction permanently removes text, vector art and image pixels under the areas you mark. A black box alone does not.



*Redaction marks on the letter.*

### Mark and redact

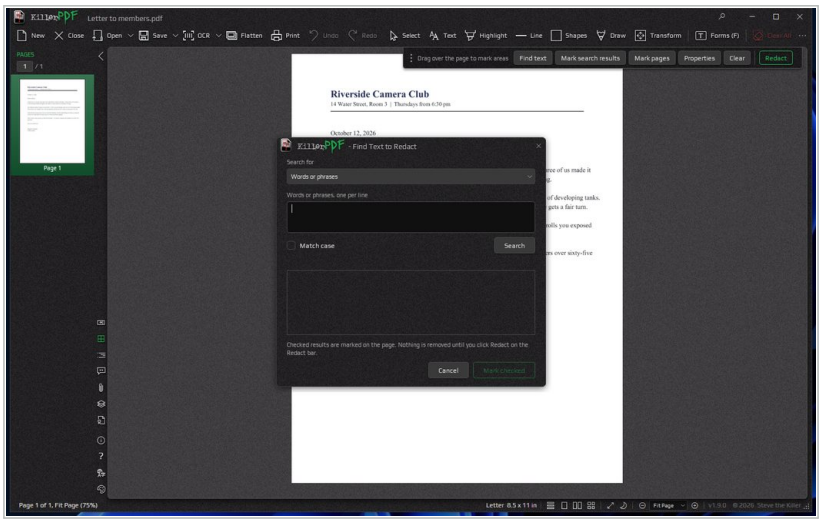
1. Press X or click Redact. The Redact bar appears.
2. Drag over the page to mark areas. The bar counts marked areas and pages.
3. To mark whole pages, click Mark pages and type the pages, such as 1, 3-5.
4. To mark every Ctrl+F match, search first, then use Mark search results.
5. Choose a fill color, a Redaction code or overlay text if you want one.
6. Click Redact.

### Good to know

- Marks are only marks until you click Redact. Clear removes them all.
- Marks survive page edits and Undo.
- If content cannot be cleaned on its own, choose Replace page with image, Replace all such pages, or Skip this page.
- Replacing a page with an image removes its old search layer. Text outside the marks stays searchable on pages cleaned without this replacement.

# Redaction: search, sanitize, verify

Let KillerPDF find the sensitive text for you, then clean up what else the file carries.




*The redaction search window with patterns.*

## Find and remove

1. In the Redact bar, choose Find text.
2. Pick a Search for option from the table below.
3. For words, type one phrase per line. Tick Match case if needed.
4. Review the results by page. Use Check all or Uncheck all.
5. Click Mark checked. Nothing is removed yet.
6. Click Redact, then pick what else to remove in Finish redaction.

## Search for

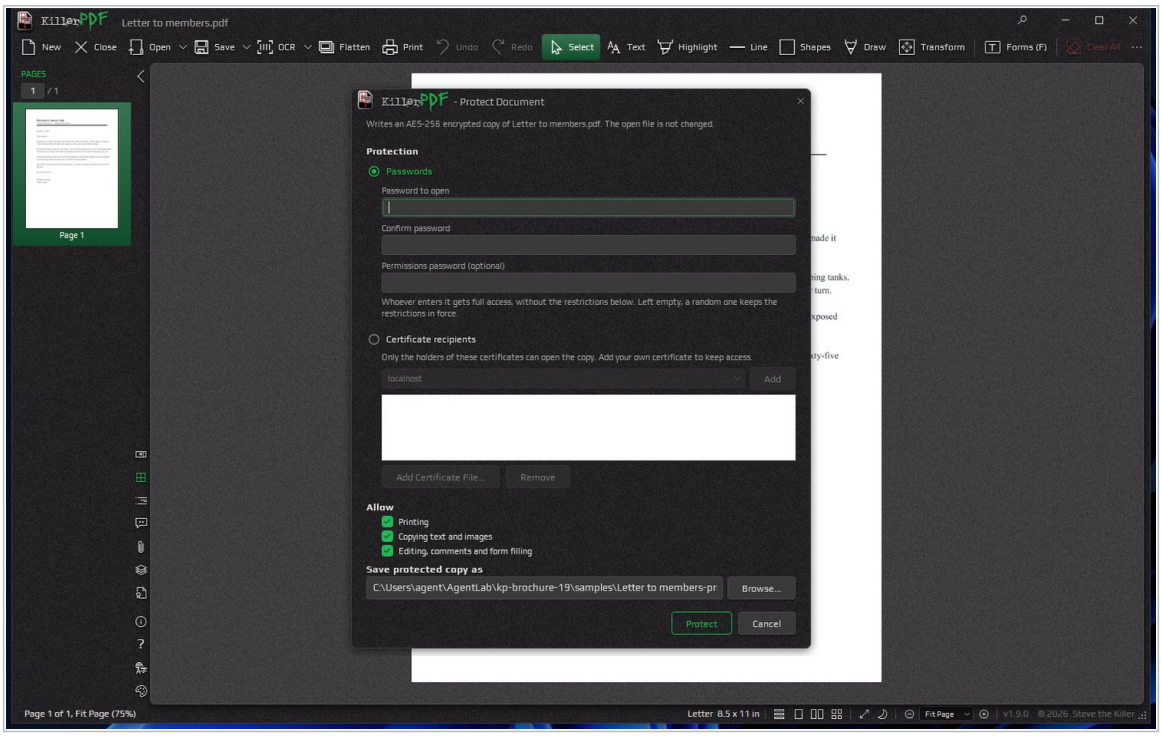
| Option | Finds |
|---|---|
| **Words or phrases** | Your text |
| **Regular expression** | Your pattern |
| **Email addresses** | Addresses |
| **Phone numbers** | North American numbers |
| **Social Security numbers** | ddd-dd-dddd or ddd dd dddd, impossible numbers rejected |
| **Credit card numbers** | 13 to 19 digits, valid checksum |
| **Bank account numbers (IBAN)** | Valid checksum |

## Sanitize and verify

- Search includes current text edits, form values, annotation text and appearance text such as button captions and stamps.
- Unreadable content is identified. Readable matches do not mean the whole document was searched.
- Finish redaction can remove comments, attached files, form fields, hidden layers, scripts, links and bookmarks. Document info, metadata and thumbnails always go.
- If removal cannot be verified, redaction is refused. Save a new file to keep the original.
- Codes for labels: 14 FOIA exemptions and 10 Privacy Act codes.

# Protect with passwords and certificates

Protect Document writes an AES-256 encrypted copy and leaves the open file alone.




*The Protect window with passwords and permissions.*

### Protect a copy

1. Save your document first, including current text and form edits. If saving is canceled or fails, protection does not continue.
2. Press Ctrl+Shift+P, or click the arrow beside Save and choose Protect Document...
3. Choose Passwords or Certificate recipients.
4. For passwords, type a Password to open and confirm it. Add a Permissions password if you want one.
5. For certificates, click Add and pick RSA certificates from the Windows store or a file.
6. Tick what to allow, then save under a different name.

### Allow

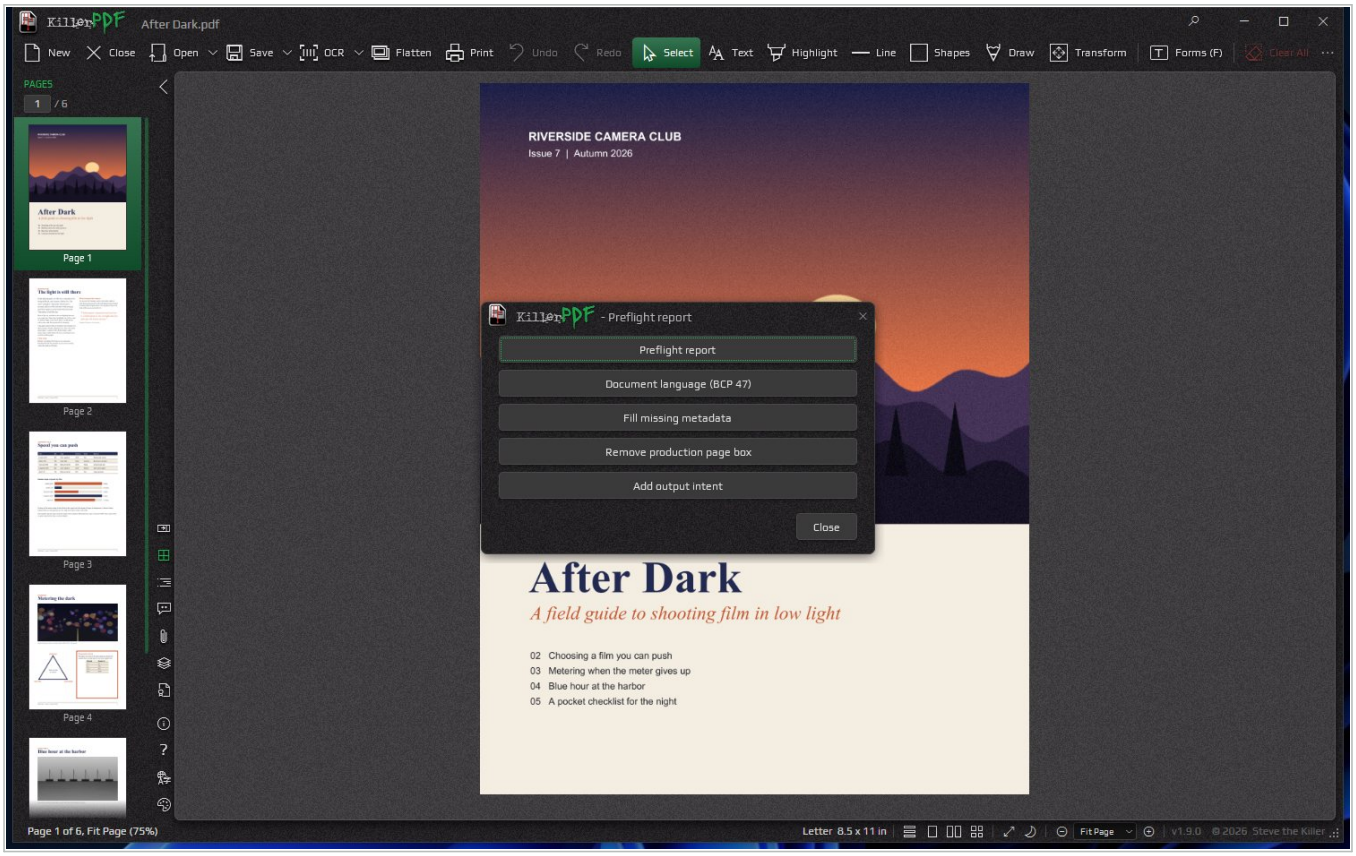
| Permission | Covers |
|---|---|
| **Printing** | Low and high quality printing |
| **Copying text and images** | Copying |
| **Editing, comments and form filling** | Edit, annotate, fill, assemble pages |

### Good to know

- Whoever enters the permissions password gets full access. If you leave it empty, a random 24-byte password keeps restrictions in force.
- Protecting a signed document asks before invalidating its signatures. Decline to keep the signed file unchanged.
- A file with owner restrictions opens read-only. Enter the owner password and click Unlock.
- Remove Password under the Save arrow works when the open file was protected.

# Preflight and accessibility reports

Check a file before it goes out. The reports list problems and offer fixes you confirm one at a time.




*The preflight report.*

## Run the checks

1. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then P, for the Preflight report.
2. Read the findings. Fixes show Before and After and apply only when you confirm.
3. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then A, for the Accessibility review.
4. Pick a problem and apply a guided repair. The review rechecks, and Undo works.
5. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then N, for the Navigation audit of links, bookmarks and destinations.
6. Open two documents in split panes and press Ctrl+Shift+D, then C, to compare their structure.

## What they check

- Preflight runs ten checks: structure, page boxes, output intent, image resolution, fonts, transparency, color, conformance declarations, layers and metadata. Defaults are 300 dpi and 300% ink.
- Preflight fixes: document language, missing metadata, a production page box, an output intent.
- Accessibility finds missing language, structure, alt text, field and link descriptions, and table headers. It does not prove a file is accessible.
- On the command line, killerpdf preflight takes a profile: general, attachments, print, or your own JSON file.

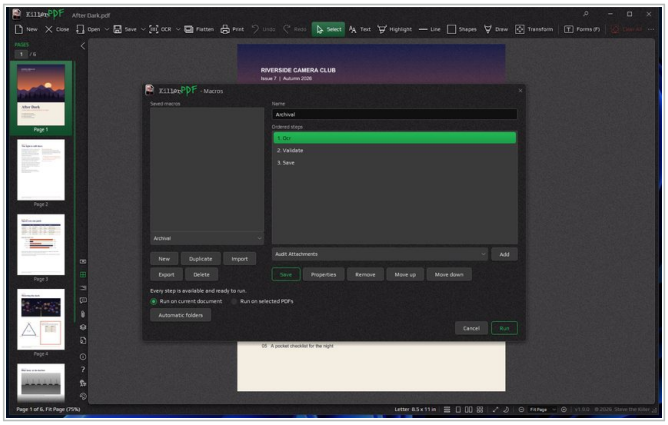
VI

# Automation

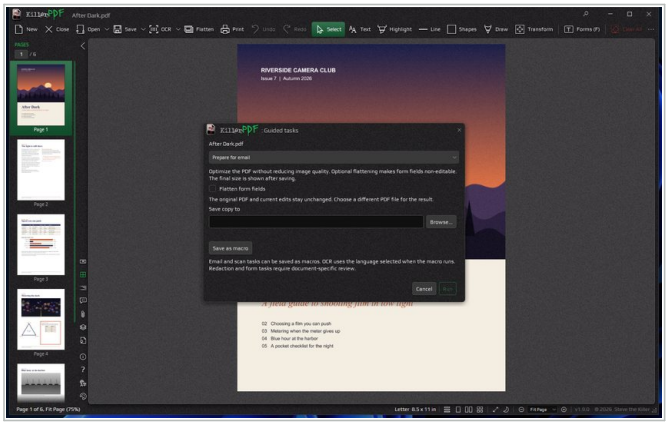
- Macros and Guided Tasks
- Watched folders and batches
- The command line, all 66 commands

# Macros and Guided tasks

A macro is a saved list of steps you can run on one PDF or many. Guided tasks walk you through common jobs.



*The Macros window.*



*Guided tasks.*

## Build a macro

1. Press Ctrl+Shift+D, then M.
2. Create a macro from a starter: Archival, Sharing, Scanning or Privacy.
3. Add, remove and reorder steps, and edit their settings.
4. Click Run on current document, review the preview, and confirm. Or choose Run on selected PDFs.
5. Export a macro as a .json file to share it.

## Guided tasks (Ctrl+Shift+D, then X)

| Task | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Prepare for email** | Optimizes the PDF |
| **Clean up a scan** | OCR, then optimize |
| **Remove sensitive information** | Review matches and marks |
| **Create a fillable form** | Review detected fields |

## Good to know

- There are 31 step types, among them OCR, Optimize, Redact, Watermark, Flatten, Export, Validate and Save.
- Guided tasks always save a copy and cannot run on signed or read-only PDFs.

# Watched folders and batch runs

Automatic folders run a saved macro on every new PDF dropped in a folder. Batch runs do the same for PDFs you pick.

## Set up a watched folder

1. Press Alt+Shift+W.
2. Choose an Input folder and a different Output folder.
3. Leave the file name filter at *.pdf or change it.
4. Choose a saved macro.
5. Click Save and start. Use Pause, Resume or Retry failed files as needed.
6. For a one-off batch, open Macros and click Run on selected PDFs.

## Limits

| Limit | Value |
|---|---|
| **File size** | 64 MB per PDF |
| **Queued jobs** | 2,000 files |
| **Subfolders** | Not scanned |
| **Passwords or input steps** | Need a manual run |

## Good to know

- It runs while KillerPDF is open, including from the system tray.
- Originals stay. New copies do not keep digital signatures.
- Install OCR models before starting.

# The command line

Most of what you can do to a PDF by hand, you can also script. Commands run without opening a window, so they work in batch files, scheduled tasks and other programs.

### How it works

Write the command as a bare word, like killerpdf merge, or in the older dashed form, KillerPDF.exe --merge. Both work for all 66 commands. The KillerPDF window can stay open while a command runs. Output goes to the console and the exit code tells a script how it went: 0 means success, 1 means the operation failed, 2 means bad usage or missing input, and 3 means the command ran and reported findings or differences (preflight, accessibility, navigation-audit, compare-structure and auto-bookmarks use it). Reports print JSON when you add --json. To keep passwords out of the command line, add --secrets-stdin and pipe in one JSON object with password, user-password, owner-password or pfx-password. One caveat: scan with --show-settings opens your scanner's own settings window.

### Three examples

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **killerpdf merge all.pdf a.pdf b.pdf scan.jpg** | Joins PDFs and images into one PDF. |
| **killerpdf preflight report.pdf --json** | Checks the file and prints findings as JSON. Exits 3 if it finds problems or cannot finish every check. |
| **killerpdf to-image book.pdf pages --dpi 200** | Writes each page as a PNG image (150 dpi is the default). |

# Command reference, part 1

All 66 commands, grouped by purpose. This page covers splitting and combining, page work, OCR and scanning, and security.

## Combine and split

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **merge** | Merges PDFs and images into one PDF. |
| **extract-pages** | Pulls pages, such as 1-3,5,9-12, into a new PDF. |
| **split** | Writes one PDF per page, or by --every, --parts, --bookmarks or --max-size. |

## Pages

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **rotate-pages** | Rotates selected pages by 90, 180 or 270 degrees. |
| **delete-pages** | Removes selected pages. |
| **move-pages** | Moves pages before a one-based position. |
| **insert-blank** | Inserts a blank page before a one-based position. |
| **duplicate-page** | Duplicates one page. |
| **reverse-pages** | Reverses the order of all or selected pages. |
| **fix-orientation** | Turns pages upright, using OCR to read scans. |
| **straighten** | Levels tilted scans that have no text layer. |
| **divide-spreads** | Splits two-page spreads into single pages. |
| **rasterize-region** | Turns one box on a page into an image. |

## OCR and scanning

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **ocr** | Adds an invisible, searchable text layer. Other languages download on first use. |
| **scan-to-text** | Turns scanned pages into real text in a matching typeface. |
| **scan** | Scans through a TWAIN scanner into a PDF. --list shows scanners. |

## Security and signing

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **redact** | Permanently removes content, by phrase, pattern, list or whole page. --dry-run previews. |
| **protect** | Saves an AES-256 copy with passwords, permissions or certificate recipients. |
| **decrypt** | Removes encryption, losslessly when possible. |
| **sign** | Adds a digital signature, optionally timestamped and visible. |

# Command reference, part 2

This page covers conversion, export and forms, plus the reports and audits that read a file without changing it.

## Conversion, export and forms

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **to-image** | Renders pages to PNG or JPEG images. |
| **flatten** | Rasterizes into an uneditable PDF, optionally with a scanned look. |
| **export** | Exports to .docx, .xlsx, .pptx, .html, .md, .txt or .json. |
| **convert-office** | Converts a Word or Excel file to PDF. |
| **replace-text** | Rewrites matching lines in their own fonts. |
| **data-merge** | Fills one copy of a form per record from CSV, JSON or XLSX. |
| **export-form-data** | Writes form data to .fdf, .xfdf or .json. |
| **import-form-data** | Fills a form from .fdf or .xfdf data. |
| **recognize-fields** | Finds form fields, and can add text fields and check boxes. |
| **xfa-to-acroform** | Converts an XFA form to standard fields. |
| **flatten-forms** | Turns form fields into page content. |
| **macro** | Runs a saved macro, a macro file or a starter. macro --list shows saved ones. |

## Reports and audits

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **preflight** | Checks a file against a profile. Exits 3 when it finds problems or cannot finish every check. |
| **accessibility** | Reports accessibility findings. Exits 3 when it finds any. |
| **document-info** | Prints document details as JSON. |
| **search-text** | Prints page hits for a query as JSON. |
| **signatures** | Lists each signature's signer, time, trust and later changes. |
| **comments** | Lists review comments and their replies. |
| **measurements** | Reports saved measurements as JSON or CSV. |
| **layers** | Lists layers with their visibility and locks. |
| **portfolio** | Shows portfolio presentation, fields and folders. |
| **attachments** | Lists embedded files, or extracts them to a folder. |
| **compare-structure** | Compares content, resources and geometry. Exits 3 when they differ. |
| **navigation-audit** | Checks links, bookmarks and destinations. Exits 3 when it finds problems. |

# Command reference, part 3

This page covers structure and navigation, print and production, and the commands for installation checks and test runs.

## Structure and navigation

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **number-pages** | Stamps page numbers, with a template, edge, alignment and number format. |
| **auto-bookmarks** | Builds an outline from detected headings. Exits 3 if it finds none. |
| **toc** | Inserts clickable contents pages built from the bookmarks. |
| **page-labels** | Sets page-label ranges, such as 1:lower-roman,5:decimal. |
| **initial-view** | Sets the page, zoom, layout and window options a viewer opens with. |
| **repair-links** | Removes unsafe or broken links. |
| **set-layer** | Renames a layer, or sets its visibility and lock. |
| **portfolio-view** | Sets a portfolio to details, tile or hidden view, or clears it. |
| **add-attachment** | Embeds one or more files in the PDF. |
| **edit-attachment** | Renames, describes, retypes or removes an embedded file. |

## Print and production

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **print** | Prints silently to a named printer, or the default one. |
| **print-production** | Reports page boxes, inks and output intents. |
| **separations** | Lists inks, or writes each page's plates as images. |
| **bates** | Stamps one continuous Bates sequence across several files. |
| **booklet** | Lays out two-up saddle-stitch imposition. |
| **nup** | Places several pages on each sheet. |
| **optimize** | Reduces file size by stripping parts and resampling images. |

## Installation and harnesses

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| **help** | Prints the usage text. |
| **version** | Prints the version. |
| **verify** | Verifies every installed payload file. |
| **batch-resave** | Resaves a file or folder tree and logs each result. Used for validation runs. |
| **batch-render** | Renders the first pages of a file or tree to PNG with per-page timings. |

VII

# The engine

- The KillerPDF.Engine
- Standards, limits and honesty
- Corpus results and components

ENGINE

# The KillerPDF.Engine

The engine is the library underneath KillerPDF 1.9. It has no user interface, so the same code can run in the app, on the command line and in your own programs.

### What it is

It is a .NET 10 library, package id KillerPdf.Engine, licensed GPL-3.0-only. It targets plain net10.0, and its source calls no Windows APIs. I have not tested it on Linux or macOS, so I will not promise it. In 1.9 it replaces PDFium, PdfPig and Docnet.Core for rendering, text extraction, search, editing, printing and export.

### What it can do

| Area | Capabilities |
|---|---|
| **Reading and recovery** | Parses classic and stream cross-references, object streams and incremental revisions, and recovers damaged files in bounded ways. Extracts words, fonts, images and paths. |
| **Rendering** | Draws pages on the CPU, including transparency, shadings, ICC color, overprint, annotations and form appearances. Decodes JPEG, JPEG 2000, JBIG2, CCITT, Flate and more. |
| **Writing and editing** | Writes deterministic full rewrites or byte-preserving incremental updates. Inserts, reorders, rotates and crops pages. Optimizes and exports. |
| **Forms and annotations** | Authors and edits AcroForm fields, reads FDF, XFDF and XFA, merges data, and handles comments, markup and measurements. |
| **Security and signing** | Password and certificate encryption, signature creation, timestamps and verification, and content redaction. |
| **Text and OCR** | Text extraction, plus its own OCR with downloadable language models. |

# Standards and security

Here is what the engine does with PDF standards, and where it stops.

| Topic | What the engine does |
|---|---|
| **PDF versions** | Reads PDF 1.x and 2.0. Authors PDF 2.0. |
| **Validates** | Checks PDF/A-4 and PDF/UA-2 declarations on existing files. Other declared PDF/A or PDF/UA parts produce unsupported findings. |
| **Authors** | PDF/A-4, PDF/A-4e, PDF/A-4f and PDF/UA-2, with safeguards that refuse output that breaks their rules. |
| **Encryption** | Opens and rewrites files protected with RC4, AES-128 or AES-256 passwords, and keeps the original encryption when it saves them. New files use AES-256, revision 6 by default, or revision 7 with AES-GCM on PDF 2.0. Certificate recipients are supported. |
| **Signatures** | Writes detached CMS signatures as incremental revisions, with RFC 3161 timestamps from a timestamp server. Verifies integrity, coverage and later changes. |
| **Trust** | Opt-in. Expired, untrusted and invalid stay separate, and embedded certificates never become trust anchors. |

### Limits

- The checks are not full PDF/A or PDF/UA validators, and PDF/X gets boundary checks only.
- The engine does not author document timestamps.
- PAdES evidence is classified, and DSS data can be written when the host supplies the evidence. It does not fetch revocation data or complete long-term validation itself.
- Rewriting or encrypting a signed document is refused unless you allow signature invalidation. Adding another signature is an incremental update that keeps the earlier ones, unless a certification signature forbids it.

# Proof: corpus and tests

I test against a large set of real and hostile PDFs. Each number below says what it was measured on and when.

| Number | What it is |
|---|---|
| **47,024** | Inputs in the corpus: 46,944 in three normal collections plus 80 damaged files. The same set was used for 1.8.90 and for the 1.9.0 corpus runs of October 2026. |
| **109 more, none lost** | Saves by 1.9.0 compared with 1.8.90, published in the 1.9.0 corpus report (follow-up run, 2026-10-15). |
| **38 to 57 percent** | Lower peak memory in that same run: standards and color 37.97, private stress 49.37, public regression 56.85. |
| **7,443** | Engine tests on the 1.9.0 development build, all passing on October 28, 2026. |
| **1,451** | App tests on the 1.9.0 development build that open no window, all passing on October 28, 2026. |

Limits

- The corpora are hostile, so some files still fail to save, and every normal batch exits 1 because of it.
- In the 2026-10-15 run, regression time was 1.74 percent longer (inside session noise). Standards and stress were 9.53 and 7.62 percent shorter.
- That run measures opening and saving, not rendering accuracy or PDF conformance.

# Components and fonts

These are the main third-party components in the KillerPDF 1.9 build, with their licenses. The full texts are in the notices file.

| Component | License |
|---|---|
| **ONNX Runtime 1.29.0** | MIT |
| **CoreJ2K 2.4.1 (JPEG 2000, vendored)** | BSD-3-Clause |
| **JBIG2 decoder, modified from Apache PDFBox** | Apache-2.0 |
| **Tesseract 5.2.0 (OCR fallback)** | Apache-2.0 |
| **Leptonica 1.82.0** | Leptonica license |
| **SixLabors.Fonts 1.0.0-beta17** | Apache-2.0 |
| **NTwain 3.7.6 (scanning, vendored)** | MIT |
| **CommunityToolkit.Mvvm 8.4.2** | MIT |
| **Liberation Fonts 2.1.5** | SIL OFL 1.1 |
| **Killer Sans, Killer Sans UI, Lacquer** | SIL OFL 1.1 |
| **Punktype (logo)** | Commercial license held by the author |

PDFium, PdfPig, Docnet.Core and PdfSharp are no longer used. Two small pieces of PDFium-derived data remain, under its BSD-style license: Symbol and ZapfDingbats font outlines, and a CMYK conversion table.

# VIII

## Reference

- Every keyboard shortcut
- Languages
- Install, update and integrations

# Keyboard shortcuts: file, tools and editing

Press F1 in the app to see the full list and a keyboard map. Bare-letter tool keys pause while you type in a text or form field.

## File

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Ctrl+O | Open |
| Ctrl+S | Save |
| Ctrl+Shift+S | Save As |
| Ctrl+W | Close file |
| Ctrl+Shift+W | Close other tabs |
| Ctrl+Shift+Q | Close all |
| Ctrl+Q | Quit |
| Ctrl+N | New blank document |
| Ctrl+P | Print |
| Ctrl+D or F4 | Document info |
| Shift+F4 | Show current file size |
| Ctrl+Shift+E | Export Document |
| Ctrl+Shift+P | Protect Document |
| Alt+Shift+T | Export table |
| Alt+Shift+E | Export Pages as Images |
| Alt+Shift+Z | Reduce File Size |
| Alt+Shift+C | Compress to ZIP |
| Alt+Shift+F | Flatten |
| Alt+Shift+B | Merge PDFs |
| Alt+Shift+X | Extract Page(s) |

## Tools

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| V | Select |
| T | Text |
| H | Highlight |
| L or U | Line |
| O | Shapes |
| Shift+O | Next shape type |
| D | Draw |
| I | Add Image |
| G | Signature |
| C | Crop |
| R | Transform |
| Ctrl+R | Rotate Page CW |
| Ctrl+Shift+R | Rotate Page CCW |
| S | Stamp Pages |
| F | Fillable text field |
| E | Color Correction |
| M | Measure |
| Shift+M | Next measurement type |
| X | Redact |
| Alt+Shift+1 | Distance |
| Alt+Shift+2 | Perimeter |
| Alt+Shift+3 | Area |
| Alt+Shift+4 | Angle |
| Alt+Shift+5 | Set the drawing scale for this page |

## Editing

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Alt+Shift+P | Edit paragraph |
| Ctrl+Z | Undo |
| Ctrl+Y or Ctrl+Shift+Z | Redo |
| Ctrl+C | Copy selected text |
| Ctrl+V | Paste image or text |
| Ctrl+B, Ctrl+I, Ctrl+U | Bold, italic, underline in a text box |
| Delete | Delete selected annotation |
| F2 | Rename |
| Ctrl+Enter | Commit a text box (Enter starts a new line) |
| Enter | Confirm a crop |
| Esc | Cancel a text or crop edit |
| Menu or Shift+F10 | Context menu at selection |

# Keyboard shortcuts: view and navigation

Views, navigation, panels, search, OCR and help. Customize Shortcuts in the F1 card lets you remap keys, and Ctrl+Shift+K turns shortcuts on and off.

## View

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| F5 | Continuous |
| F6 | Single Page |
| F7 | Two Page |
| B | Book layout |
| F8 | Grid |
| F10 | Split pane |
| F11 or Esc | Full screen |
| Alt+M | Hide toolbar |
| N | Invert document colors |
| Shift+N | Invert images too |
| Ctrl+Shift++, Ctrl+Shift+-, Ctrl+Shift+0 | Zoom the whole app |
| Wheel on logo | Zoom the whole app |
| Alt+Shift+G | Film Grain |
| Alt+Shift+N | Show page navigation buttons |
| Ctrl+Shift+1 to 6 | Toolbar appearance |
| Alt+Shift+Up | Tabs on top |
| Alt+Shift+Down | Tabs on bottom |

## Navigation

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Left, Right, PgUp, PgDn | Previous or next page |
| Home, End | First or last page |
| Alt+Left, Alt+Right | Back or forward in jump history |
| Up, Down | Scroll, flipping the page at the edges |
| Ctrl+Scroll | Zoom in or out around the cursor |
| Ctrl++, Ctrl+- | Zoom in or out |
| Ctrl+0 | Reset zoom to 100 percent |
| Ctrl+1, Ctrl+2, Ctrl+3 | Actual size, fit width, fit page |
| Middle drag | Pan view |
| Space + drag | Pan view |
| F9 | Toggle sidebar |
| Shift+F9 | Move sidebar to the next side |
| Ctrl+Tab | Next tab |
| Ctrl+Shift+Tab | Previous tab |
| Ctrl+Shift+N | Move to New Window |

## Panels

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Alt+1 | Pages |
| Alt+2 | Outline |
| Alt+3 | Comments and measurements |
| Alt+4 | Attachments |
| Alt+5 | Layers |
| Alt+6 | Signatures |

## Search and select

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Ctrl+K | Search Tools |
| Ctrl+F | Find Text |
| Ctrl+H | Find and replace |
| F3 or Enter | Next result |
| Shift+F3 or Shift+Enter | Previous result |
| Ctrl+A | Select all text on page |
| Shift+Click | Add to selection |

## OCR and help

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Ctrl+Shift+O | OCR Page (Copy Text) |
| Ctrl+Shift+I | OCR Region |
| Ctrl+Shift+T | Convert Scan to Text |
| F1 or Ctrl+? | This shortcut list |
| F12 | About dialog |
| Ctrl+Shift+K | Toggle keyboard shortcuts |

# Keyboard shortcuts: document tools

Press Ctrl+Shift+D to open the Document tools menu, then press the letter beside a tool to run it. A few document tools also have their own direct keys.

Direct keys

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Ctrl+Shift+D | Document tools menu |
| Ctrl+Shift+G | Digital Signature |
| Alt+Shift+V | Compare PDFs |
| Alt+Shift+W | Automatic folders |
| Alt+Shift+A | Add Blank Page |
| Alt+Shift+R | Reverse Page Order |
| Alt+Shift+O | Fix Page Orientation |
| Alt+Shift+S | Straighten Scanned Pages |
| Alt+Shift+D | Divide Spreads |
| Alt+Shift+L | Rasterize Region |

Document tools chord: press Ctrl+Shift+D, then the letter

| Keys | Action |
|---|---|
| Ctrl+Shift+D, P | Preflight report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, R | Print production report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, S | Separation preview report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, A | Accessibility review |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, W | Signatures report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, Z | Certificates |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, L | Layers report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, E | Edit layers |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, F | Portfolio report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, O | Edit portfolio |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, U | Edit portfolio structure |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, T | Edit attachments |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, K | Comments |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, Y | Measurements |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, N | Navigation audit |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, B | Create bookmarks from headings |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, G | Edit page labels |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, V | Initial view settings |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, C | Structural comparison report |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, X | Guided tasks |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, M | Macros |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, D | Data merge |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, I | Insert table of contents |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, H | Form data |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, J | Bookmark data |
| Ctrl+Shift+D, Q | Production layouts and Bates batches |

# Interface languages

KillerPDF's interface comes in 20 languages. Dates and numbers keep your Windows regional format whatever language you pick.

### The 20 languages

| Language | Shown in the menu as | Code |
|---|---|---|
| **English** | English | en-US |
| **Bengali** | বাংলা | bn |
| **Czech** | Čeština | cs-CZ |
| **German** | Deutsch | de-DE |
| **Spanish** | Español | es |
| **French** | Français | fr-FR |
| **Hungarian** | Magyar | hu-HU |
| **Italian** | Italiano | it-IT |
| **Japanese** | 日本語 | ja-JP |
| **Kazakh** | Қазақша | kk-KZ |
| **Norwegian Bokmål** | Norsk bokmål | nb-NO |
| **Polish** | Polski | pl-PL |
| **Portuguese (Brazil)** | Português (Brasil) | pt-BR |
| **Russian** | Русский | ru-RU |
| **Slovenian** | Slovenščina | sl-SI |
| **Turkish** | Türkçe | tr-TR |
| **Ukrainian** | Українська | uk-UA |
| **Vietnamese** | Tiếng Việt | vi-VN |
| **Chinese (Simplified)** | 中文 (简体) | zh-CN |
| **Chinese (Traditional)** | 中文 (繁體) | zh-TW |

### Switching

- Click the Language button on the sidebar rail and pick a language. The interface changes at once.
- On first run KillerPDF follows your Windows display language, or English if it has no match.
- Any text a language file lacks falls back to English. Slovenian is new in 1.9.

REFERENCE

# Install, update and requirements

KillerPDF comes as an installer, a portable file and a Store package. The app never needs administrator rights; only a machine-wide install asks for them.

### Ways to get it

| Option | Details |
|---|---|
| **Installer** | KillerPDF.exe. Choose Install for my account or Install for everyone on this computer. Needs the x64 .NET 10 Desktop Runtime. |
| **Portable** | KillerPDF-Portable.exe. One file, no install, runtime included. Data sits in a KillerPDF-Data folder beside it. |
| **Microsoft Store** | A package with the runtime included. |
| **WinGet** | Package id SteveTheKiller.KillerPDF (winget install SteveTheKiller.KillerPDF) |
| **Chocolatey** | Package id killerpdf |

### Updates, files and requirements

- On startup KillerPDF checks GitHub for a newer release (on by default) and asks before installing. It checks the file's checksum and its publisher signature first.
- KillerPDF adds itself to the Open with list for .pdf files without changing your default PDF app, and a file you launch from the same Windows session opens in the running copy as a new tab.
- Requires 64-bit Windows. The installer edition needs the x64 .NET 10 Desktop Runtime; the Portable and Store editions include it.

REFERENCE

# KillerMCP and KillerNotes

KillerPDF works with AI agents through KillerMCP, a separate project. The integration lives in KillerMCP, not in the KillerPDF app. You reach the note tools by asking your AI agent, since KillerPDF itself has no menu item for saving to KillerNotes.

### KillerMCP

KillerMCP drives your installed KillerPDF through its command line. It registers with Codex, Claude Code, Claude Desktop, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Gemini CLI and Windsurf when it finds them. Each source PDF can be up to 64 MiB. Merge takes 2 to 8 PDFs, up to 128 MiB combined. Tools that make files need a new output path and refuse to overwrite.

#### Save as note, when KillerNotes is also installed

| Tool | What it does |
|---|---|
| **killerpdf_save_text_as_note** | Exports a PDF's text as Markdown and saves it as one new note. |
| **killerpdf_save_report_as_note** | Runs a report (signatures, comments, measurements or preflight findings) and saves it as a note. It never changes the PDF. |
| **killerpdf_save_pages_as_notes** | Renders selected pages and saves each page image as a new note. |

# KillerPDF

## Colophon

### DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT

KillerPDF and this guide are designed and built by Steve the Killer.

### LICENSE

KillerPDF and the KillerPDF.Engine are free software under the GPL-3.0.

### TYPE

Titles in Killer Sans. The wordmark sets "Killer" in Punktype by junkohanhero and "PDF" in Lacquer. Body text in Helvetica.

### SCREENSHOTS

Every screenshot is KillerPDF 1.9 running on Windows 11 at 100 percent scaling.

### SAMPLE DOCUMENTS

The camera club guide, form and letter in the screenshots were written for this guide. Their photos are generated, not borrowed.

### THIS FILE

Made with ReportLab from source facts checked against the KillerPDF code. Open it in KillerPDF and use the bookmarks to jump around.